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United States Patent	12415308
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Harasawa; Yuki et al.

Structural body manufacturing method and panel

Abstract

A method of manufacturing a structure is provided in which a burr portion can be more reliably cut. In a burr portion shaping step, the burr portion is sucked to an engaging portion by a suction part to shape the burr portion along the engaging portion, and in a cutting step, a movable portion is moved relative to first and second split molds with the burr portion being shaped along the engaging portion, thereby the burr portion is cut from a molded main body along a cutting line.

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Appl. No.:	18/546468
Filed (or PCT Filed):	February 18, 2022
PCT No.:	PCT/JP2022/006665
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2022/181487
PCT Pub. Date:	September 01, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240131777 A1	Apr. 25, 2024
US 20240227277 A9	Jul. 11, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2021-030769	Feb. 26, 2021
JP	2021-030774	Feb. 26, 2021
JP	2021-138343	Aug. 26, 2021
JP	2021-192085	Nov. 26, 2021

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: B29C51/26 (20060101); B29C51/32 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC B29C51/268 (20130101); B29C51/32 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B29C (51/105); B29C (51/265); B29C (51/006); B29C (51/32); B29C (37/02); B29C (51/10); B29C (51/36); B29C (51/268); B29C (2793/009); B29D (7/00)

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This invention relates to a method of manufacturing a structure and to a panel that can be bent at the hinge.

BACKGROUND ART

Common to First and Second Viewpoints

(2) Patent Literature 1 discloses a method of molding a resin panel using a mold, wherein the mold has a pinch-off portion surrounding a cavity. In the molding method in Patent Literature 1, placed in the cavity are a core member consisting of, for example, a foamed body, a resin sheet covering the core member, and a skin material made of, for example, non-woven fabric, and these members are molded together in the cavity. The molded body produced as described above includes a molded main body molded in the cavity, and a burr portion placed outside the cavity.

(3) Patent Literature 1 discloses a method for cutting the burr portion using a movable portion provided on the mold. The movable portion of Patent Literature 1 is driven away from the mold to cut the burr portion from the resin sheet that constitutes the molded main body.

Third Viewpoint

(4) Patent Literature 2 discloses a method of manufacturing a resin structure using a mold and an outer frame arranged around the mold. The outer frame of Patent Literature 2 moves forward so as to protrude from the mold, contacts a hung resin sheet, and is capable of suctioning the resin sheet. When the outer frame sucks the resin sheet, the space (cavity) between the resin sheet and the mold becomes a closed space. Therefore, by reducing the pressure in this space, the resin sheet can be shaped along the mold.

Fourth Viewpoint

(5) Patent Literature 3 discloses a resin panel with a thin hinge.

CITATION LIST

Patent Literature

(6) [Patent Literature 1] WO-A-2020/026928 [Patent Literature 2] JP-A-2018-122462 [Patent Literature 3] JP-A-2019-051649

SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

First Viewpoint

(7) Depending on the configuration of the burr portion (e.g., material, shape, and surface area, etc.), the movable portion of Patent Literature 1 may have difficulty engaging the burr portion. In such cases, the burr portion does not move with the movable portion when the movable portion is driven, increasing the possibility that the burr portion will not be cut from the resin sheet.

(8) The present invention has been made in view of such circumstances, and an objective thereof is to provide a method of manufacturing a structure, in which a burr portion can be more reliably cut off.

Second Viewpoint

(9) In Patent Literature 1, the pinch-off portion is formed at the edge of the mold, and the movable portion is butted against the pinch-off portion when the movable portion is in the initial position.

(10) Therefore, in Patent Literature 1, a cutting line of the burr portion is the position corresponding to the pinch-off portion. Although the shape of the pinch-off portion is determined according to the shape of the molded body, when the movable portion is not smoothly connected to a portion where the movable portion and the pinch-off portion are butted against each other, the cutting line may be distorted, making it difficult to cut the burr portion.

(11) The present invention has been made in view of such circumstances, and an objective thereof is to provide a method of manufacturing a structure to suppress a burr portion from becoming difficult to cut.

Third Viewpoint

(12) In order to properly shaping the resin sheet along the mold, the outer frame should be retracted to some extent from a forward position. Depending on the amount of retraction of the outer frame and the shape of the mold, the resin sheet may have difficulty following a mold surface, causing the resin sheet to peel off from the mold surface and outer frame, resulting in molding defects.

(13) The present invention has been made in view of such circumstances, and the objective thereof is to provide a method for manufacturing a structure to suppress molding defects.

Fourth Viewpoint

(14) One possible approach is to make the hinge unit thinner so that it can be easily bent. However, it is difficult to manufacture such a thin hinge with high yield, and slight manufacturing variations can cause problems such as unwanted pinch-off at the hinge. There are limitations to the approach of pursuing such a thinner hinge.

(15) The present invention has been made in view of such circumstances, and the objective thereof is to provide a panel having a hinge with improved bendability.

Solution to Problem

First Viewpoint

(16) According to the present invention, provided is a method for manufacturing a structure, comprising: a molding step; a burr portion shaping step; and a cutting step, wherein, in the molding step, a molded body is molded using a mold, the mold includes a movable portion and a pair of first and second split molds, each of the first and second split molds includes a cavity and a pinch-off portion, the movable portion is provided to be movable relative to the first and second split molds, and the movable portion includes a suction part and an engaging portion, the molded body includes a molded main body, a cutting line, and a burr portion, the molded main body is molded in the cavity in the molding step, the cutting line is squashed by the pinch-off portion in the molding step; and the burr portion is connected to the molded main body via the cutting line, and is provided on the movable portion, in the burr portion shaping step, the burr portion is shaped along the engaging portion by suctioning the burr portion to the engaging portion via the suction part, in the cutting step, the burr portion is cut from the molded main body along the cutting line by moving the movable portion relative to the first and second split molds with the burr portion shaped along the engaging portion.

(17) In the burr portion shaping step, the burr portion is suctioned to the engaging portion of the movable portion via the suction part. As a result, the burr portion is shaped along the movable portion and the burr portion engages the movable portion more securely. Therefore, when the movable portion is moved relative to the first and second split molds, the burr portion is restrained from sliding against the movable portion, and the burr portion moves to follow the movable portion, resulting in the burr portion being more securely cut from the molded main body.

(18) Hereinafter, various embodiments of the present invention will be described.

(19) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the first split mold includes an end face portion, the movable portion includes a butting surface portion, and in the burr portion shaping step, the

butting surface portion is butted against the end face portion.

(20) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the mold further includes a sealing member, and the sealing member is attached to the end face portion or the butting surface portion.

(21) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the first split mold includes a first outer portion, the pinch-off portion of the first split mold is formed on the first outer portion, and the end face portion is formed on the first outer portion, the second split mold includes a second outer portion, and the pinch-off portion of the second split mold is formed on the second outer portion, and the second outer portion is positioned to face the first outer portion in a direction in which the first and second split molds open and close.

(22) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the molded body includes a resin sheet and a skin material, and the skin material is disposed on an outer side of the resin sheet.

(23) Preferably, provided is the method wherein each of the first and second split molds includes a reduced pressure suction hole, the reduced pressure suction hole communicates with the cavity, and the reduced pressure suction hole is formed to shape the resin sheet along the first and second split molds, with the first and second split molds shaping the resin sheet, the skin material in the cavity is provided along the first split mold, and the reduced pressure suction hole is not formed in the first outer portion of the first split mold.

(24) Preferably, provided is the method wherein a skin material escape space is formed between the first outer portion and the second outer portion, and in the molding step, an edge of the skin material is disposed in the skin material escape space.

Second Viewpoint

(25) According to the present invention, provided is a method for manufacturing a structure, comprising: a molding step; an engaging step; and a cutting step, wherein, in the molding step, a molded body is molded using a mold, the mold includes a movable portion and a pair of first and second split molds, each of the first and second split molds includes a cavity, an inner pinch-off portion, and an outer pinch-off portion, the inner pinch-off portion is connected to the cavity, the outer pinch-off portion is located further away from the cavity than the inner pinch-off portion, the movable portion is provided to be movable relative to the first and second split molds, and the movable portion includes an engaging portion, the molded body includes a molded main body, an outer line portion, and an outer burr portion, the molded main body includes an inner line portion and an inner burr portion, the molded main body is molded in the cavity in the molding step, the inner line portion is squashed by the inner pinch-off portion in the molding step, the inner burr portion is formed between the inner line portion and the outer line portion, the outer line portion is squashed by the outer pinch-off portion in the molding step, the outer burr portion is connected to the outer line portion, in the engaging step, the outer burr portion is engaged with the engaging portion of the movable portion, and in the cutting step, the outer burr portion is cut from the inner burr portion along the outer line portion by moving the movable portion relative to the first and second split molds with the outer burr portion engaged with the engaging portion.

(26) In the present invention, each of the first and second split molds has an inner pinch-off portion connected to the cavity and an outer pinch-off portion located farther from the inner pinch-off portion with respect to the cavity. Here, the outer pinch-off portion is a portion that is not connected to the cavity and that defines the unwanted inner and outer burr portions. Therefore, the outer pinch-off portion is not subject to the same restrictions as the inner pinch-off portion, such as conforming to the shape of the periphery of the molded main body. Thus, in the present invention, the pinch-off portion can be easily set to a shape that takes into account the connection with the movable portion to the extent that the restrictions are suppressed, and as a result, the burr portion can be suppressed from being difficult to cut.

(27) Hereinafter, various embodiments of the present invention will be described.

(28) Preferably, provided is the method wherein, when the first split mold and the movable portion are viewed in plan view, the outer pinch-off portion is formed along the engaging portion.

(29) Preferably, provided is the method wherein, a surface of a top portion of the outer pinch-off portion is aligned with the surface of a top portion of the engaging portion.

(30) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the movable portion further includes a suction part, and in the engaging step, the outer burr portion is suctioned to the engaging portion via the suction part, the outer burr portion is shaped along the engaging portion, and thereby the outer burr portion is engaged along the engaging portion.

(31) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the first split mold includes an end face portion, the movable portion includes a butting surface portion, and in the engaging step, with the butting surface portion butted against the end face portion, the outer burr portion is suctioned to the engaging portion via the suction part.

(32) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the mold further includes a sealing member, and the sealing member is attached to the end face portion or the butting surface portion.

(33) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the first split mold includes a first outer portion, the first outer portion includes the inner pinch-off portion and the outer pinch-off portion of the first split mold, and the first outer portion includes the end face portion, the second split mold includes a second outer portion, and the second outer portion includes the inner pinch-off portion and the outer pinch-off portion of the second split mold, and the second outer portion is positioned to face the first outer portion in a direction in which the first and second split molds open and close.

(34) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the molded body includes a resin sheet and a skin material, and the skin material is disposed on an outer side of the resin sheet.

(35) Preferably, provided is the method wherein each of the first and second split molds includes a reduced pressure suction hole, the reduced pressure suction hole communicates with the cavity, and the reduced pressure suction hole is formed to shape the resin sheet along the first and second split molds, with the first and second split molds shaping the resin sheet, the skin material in the cavity is provided along the first split mold, and the reduced pressure suction hole is not formed in the first outer portion of the first split mold.

(36) Preferably, provided is the method wherein a skin material escape space is formed between the first outer portion and the second outer portion, and in the molding step, an edge of the skin material is disposed in the skin material escape space.

Third Viewpoint

(37) According to the present invention, provided is a method for manufacturing a structure using a mold and an outer frame, the method comprising: a hanging step; a suction step, and a shaping step, wherein, in the hanging step, a molten resin sheet is hung in front of the mold, the mold includes a cavity, a pinch-off portion, and a chamfer portion, the chamfer portion is provided between the outer frame and the pinch-off portion and is formed so that the distance between the chamfer portion and the hung resin sheet increases in a direction from the pinch-off portion to the outer frame, in the suction step, the outer frame is advanced and the resin sheet is suctioned by the outer frame to form a closed space between the outer frame, the resin sheet, and the mold, the outer frame is positioned around the mold and is configured to suck the resin sheet, in the shaping step, the outer frame is backed and the closed space is depressurized to shape the resin sheet by the cavity, and the resin sheet moves with the outer frame as the outer frame is backed and is positioned along the chamfer portion.

(38) In the present invention, since the mold includes the chamfer portion, when the resin sheet moves with the outer frame in the shaping step, the resin sheet is smoothly placed along the chamfer portion. This prevents the resin sheet from peeling off from the mold or the outer frame, thereby avoiding molding defects.

(39) Hereinafter, various embodiments of the present invention will be described.

(40) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the chamfer portion includes a tapered surface.

(41) Preferably, provided is the method wherein a slope angle of the tapered surface is equal to or less than 60 degrees.

- (42) Preferably, provided is the method wherein, in the shaping step, the outer frame is backed up to a position of a rear edge portion of the chamfer portion.
- (43) Preferably, provided is the method wherein, in the shaping step, distance in which the outer frame is backed is within a range from 30 mm to 80 mm.
- (44) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the method further using a movable portion, and the method further comprises a molding step, the mold includes first and second split molds, the movable portion is configured to move relative to the first split mold to cut a portion of the resin sheet, and is provided around the first split mold, the second split mold includes the chamfer portion, and the outer frame is positioned around the second split mold, and in the molding step, the first and second split molds are closed, and when the molding step is completed, at least a portion of the movable portion is positioned closer to the outer frame than a position of a front edge portion of the chamfer portion.
- (45) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the chamfer portion has a width in a direction in which the mold opens and closes, and the width is within a range from 10 mm to 63 mm.
- (46) Preferably, provided is the method wherein the chamfer portion has a width in a direction from the pinch-off portion to the outer frame, and the width is within a range from 5.7 mm to 70 mm.

Fourth Viewpoint

- (47) According to the present invention, provided is a panel comprising: a resin panel body, wherein the resin panel body includes a first body portion, a second body portion, and a hinge, the first and second body portions and the hinge are integrated, the hinge includes a hinge part and a slit, the hinge part connects the first body portion and the second body portion in a rotatable manner, and the slit is provided next to the hinge part and separates the first body portion from the second body portion.
- (48) In the present invention, the slit can improve the bendability of the hinge.
- (49) Hereinafter, various embodiments of the present invention will be described. The embodiments described hereinafter can be combined with each other.
- (50) Preferably, the panel further comprising a skin material, wherein the skin material is attached on the first body portion and the second body portion across the hinge portion.
- (51) Preferably, $L_{sub.S}/L_{sub.0}$ is within a range from 0.50 to 0.99, $L_{sub.0}$ is a total length over both ends of the hinge, and $L_{sub.S}$ is a total length of the slit.
- (52) Preferably, the hinge part includes extremity hinge parts, and the extremity hinge parts are provided at both ends of the hinge, respectively.
- (53) Preferably, the hinge part includes a middle hinge part, and the middle hinge part is provided between the extremity hinge parts.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a resin panel **1** of embodiments of the first through third viewpoints. FIG. 1B is a perspective view of a core member **3** of the embodiments of the first through third viewpoints.
- (2) FIG. 2A is an exploded perspective view of the core member **3** according to the embodiments of the first through third viewpoints. FIG. 2B is an enlarged view of area B of FIG. 2A. FIG. 2C is an end view of a reinforcing member **3c**.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a front view of a molding machine **10** of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoint (first and second split molds **21**, **22** and their nearby components are cross-sectional views). In FIG. 3, a drive mechanism **24** shown in FIG. 5 is omitted.
- (4) FIG. 4A is a perspective view of an inserting device **19** of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 4B illustrates the core member **3** being attached to the inserting device **19**.

(5) FIG. 5 illustrates a perspective view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** in a state in which the molds are open, in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints.

(6) FIG. 6 is an enlarged view of area A of FIG. 5.

(7) FIG. 7 is a perspective view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** seen from a different direction from that shown in FIG. 5.

(8) FIG. 8 is an enlarged view of area A of FIG. 7.

(9) FIG. 9A is a perspective view of a pair of movable portions **23** of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 9B is an enlarged view of area B of FIG. 9A.

(10) FIG. 10A and FIG. 10B are front views showing the operation of the movable portion **23** when performing a first cutting step of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints.

(11) FIG. 11 is an illustration corresponding to FIG. 3 to explain a molding step of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints.

(12) FIG. 12 is an end view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** closed and the movable portion **23** in the initial position in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 12 corresponds to the A-A end in FIG. 3.

(13) FIG. 13 illustrates a state in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints, after an engaging step (a burr portion shaping step) and at the start of the first cutting step. FIG. 13 is an end view corresponding to area A of FIG. 12.

(14) FIG. 14 is an illustration of the operation of the first cutting step of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 14 illustrates the movable portion **23** moving away from the first split mold **21** and an outer burr portion **5bc2** being cut from the inner burr portion **5bc1**.

(15) FIG. 15 is a front view of a molded body **5** of the embodiments of the first to third viewpoints.

(16) FIG. 16 shows a schematic front view in which, in the first and second viewpoints, the outer burr portion **5bc2** of the molded body **5** in FIG. 13 is cut off from an inner burr portion **5bc1**. In FIG. 16, in the first and second viewpoints, the outer burr portion **5bc2** is pulled by the movable portion **23** and torn along a right line **5cr** and a left line **5cl**. FIG. 16 illustrates a schematic front view of a state in which, in the third viewpoint, the outer burr portion **5bc2** of the molded body **5** is cut off from the inner burr portion **5bc1** by the implementation of the first cutting step.

(17) FIG. 17 is an end view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** for a modification of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 17 illustrates a state at which the first cutting step starts.

(18) FIG. 18 is an illustration of the operation of the first cutting step in the modification of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints.

(19) FIG. 19 is a cross-sectional view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** used in manufacturing a resin panel having a hinge in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 19 shows a cross-sectional view in a plane passing through the hinge of the resin panel and parallel to the direction of extension of the hinge.

(20) FIG. 20A is an exploded view of the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** for modification 2 of the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints. FIG. 20B is an exploded perspective view from a different direction from FIG. 20A. FIG. 20C illustrates a state in which the movable portion **23** is supported by the supporting portion **21f**.

(21) FIG. 21 is a front view of the molding machine **10** of the embodiments of the third viewpoint (the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, the outer frame **31**, and the core member **3**, etc. are illustrated in cross section).

(22) FIG. 22 is a perspective view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** and outer frames **31**, **32**, showing a state where the first and second split molds **21**, **22** open in the embodiments of the third viewpoint.

(23) FIG. 23 is an enlarged view of area A of FIG. 22.

(24) FIG. 24 is a perspective view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** and the outer frames **31**, **32**, viewed from a different direction than in FIG. 22. In FIGS. 28 to 34, the first and second

split molds **21**, **22**, etc. are illustrated with their end faces cut in a horizontal plane passing through left and right points **P1** of FIG. **24**. In FIG. **26** and FIG. **27**, the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, etc. are illustrated with end planes cut in a vertical plane passing through upper and lower points **P2** of FIG. **24**.

(25) FIGS. **25A** to **25C** are front views showing the movement of the movable portion **23** when performing a first cutting step of the embodiments of the third viewpoint.

(26) FIG. **26** illustrates a state where a skin material attaching step is completed and a hanging step is being carried out, in the embodiments of the third viewpoint.

(27) FIG. **27** illustrates a state where a suction step is being carried out in the embodiments of the third viewpoint.

(28) FIG. **28** illustrates a horizontal end view of the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, etc. of FIG. **27**.

(29) FIG. **29** is an enlarged view of the area **A** of FIG. **28**. In FIG. **29**, dashed lines **L1**, **L5** correspond to a position of a rear edge portion **22ab**, dashed lines **L2**, **L4** correspond to a position of a front edge portion **22af**, and a dashed line **L3** corresponds to a position of a front edge surface of the outer frame **32**.

(30) FIG. **30** illustrates a shaping step for the third viewpoint.

(31) FIG. **31** illustrates a state where a core member welding step of the embodiments of the third viewpoint is performed.

(32) FIG. **32** illustrates a state where a molding step of the embodiment of the third viewpoint is performed.

(33) FIG. **33** is an enlarged view of a principal portion of the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, etc. illustrated in FIG. **32**. In FIG. **33**, the dashed line **T1** corresponds to a position of the front edge portion of the outer frame **32**, the dashed line **T2** corresponds to a position of a front edge portion of a suction part **23g**, and the dashed line **T3** corresponds to a position of an opposing surface portion **23a**.

(34) FIG. **34** illustrates a state where the first cutting step of the embodiments of the third viewpoint is performed. FIG. **34** illustrates the movable portion **23** moving away from the first split mold **21** and the outer burr portion **5bc2** being cut from the inner burr portion **5bc1**.

(35) FIG. **35A** is a plan view of a panel viewed from a front surface side (i.e. skin material side), and FIG. **35B** is a side view of the panel.

(36) FIG. **36A** is a plan view of the panel as viewed from a back surface side, and FIG. **36B** is a cross-sectional view along the A-A line.

(37) FIG. **37** is an enlarged plan view of portions **B1** to **B3** of FIG. **36** on the back side of the panel.

(38) FIG. **38** is a cross-sectional view along the C-C line of FIG. **37**.

(39) FIG. **39** is a cross-sectional view illustrating an example of how a hinge bends.

(40) FIG. **40** is a configuration diagram of the molding machine **10** that can be used to manufacture a panel (a longitudinal sectional view for molds **121**, **131** and their nearby components).

(41) FIG. **41** is a cross-sectional view illustrating how the mold is closed at a position in the dashed line **D** in FIG. **40**.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(42) Hereinafter, various embodiments of the present invention will be described. Various features described in the following embodiments can be combined with each other. In addition, an invention can be established independently for each of the features.

Common to First and Second Viewpoints

1. Resin Panel **1**

(43) As illustrated in FIG. **1A** and FIG. **1B**, a resin panel **1** (an example of a “structure”) of one embodiment of the present invention is a panel covered with a resin molded body **2** and has a rectangular shape in plan view.

(44) As illustrated in FIG. **1A** to FIG. **2C**, the resin panel **1** includes a hollow resin molded body **2**

and a core member **3**, wherein the core member **3** is placed within the resin molded body **2**. A skin material **4** is attached to one side of the resin molded body **2** so as to extend to a parting line PL. The skin material **4** is, for example, a non-woven fabric, and is integrally molded into the resin molded body **2** during the molding process.

(45) Both sides of the core material **3** are in close contact with the resin molded body **2**. The core material **3** includes base bodies **3a**, **3b** and a reinforcing member **3c** connecting them.

(46) The reinforcing member **3c** is an elongated member having a constant cross section. The base bodies **3a**, **3b** are made of, for example, a foam. The reinforcing member **3c** is substantially H-shaped and includes an upper wall **3c1**, a lower wall **3c2**, and a pillar portion **3c3** connecting them. Projections **3c11** projecting toward the lower wall **3c2** are provided at both ends of the upper wall **3c1** in the width direction. Projections **3c21** projecting toward the upper wall **3c1** are provided at both ends of the lower wall **3c2** in the width direction. The projections **3c11**, **3c21** are engaged with the base bodies **3a**, **3b**, so that the base bodies **3a**, **3b** and the reinforcing member **3c** are integrated. Ends of the base bodies **3a**, **3b** are provided with recessed portions **3a1**, **3b1** formed one step lower, and the upper wall **3c1** and the lower wall **3c2** are accommodated in the recessed portions **3a1**, **3b1**, so that upper and lower surfaces of the base bodies **3a**, **3b** and the reinforcing member **3c** are substantially flush with each other.

2. Manufacturing Method for Resin Panel **1**

(47) 2-1. Description of Manufacturing Apparatus

(48) As shown in FIG. **3**, the manufacturing method of the embodiment uses a molding machine **10** and an insertion apparatus **19** to form the molded body **5** shown in FIG. **15**. As illustrated in FIGS. **3** to **9**, the molding machine **10** includes a pair of sheet forming devices **14**, first and second split molds **21**, **22**, a movable portion **23**, and a drive mechanism **24**.

2-1-1. Configuration of Sheet Forming Device **14**

(49) As illustrated in FIG. **3**, each sheet forming device **14** has a hopper **12**, an extruder **13**, an accumulator **17**, and a T-die **18**. The extruder **13** and the accumulator **17** are connected via a connecting tube **15**. The accumulator **17** and the T-die **18** are connected via a connecting tube **16**. Details of each component will be described below.

(50) <Hopper **12**, Extruder **13**>

(51) The hopper **12** is used to feed raw resin **11** into a cylinder **13a** of the extruder **13**. The form of the raw resin **11** is not particularly limited and is usually in the form of pellets. The raw resin is, for example, a thermoplastic resin, such as polyolefin, and examples of the polyolefin include low-density polyethylene, linear low-density polyethylene, high-density polyethylene, polypropylene, ethylene-propylene copolymer, and a mixture thereof. The raw resin **11** may contain recycled raw material produced by pulverizing a burr portion in the pulverizer. The raw resin **11** is fed into the cylinder **13a** from the hopper **12** and is heated and melted in the cylinder **13a** to become molten resin. Further, the raw resin is further conveyed toward a tip of the cylinder **13a** by the rotation of a screw pump arranged inside the cylinder **13a**. The screw pump is arranged inside the cylinder **13a**, and the molten resin is kneaded and conveyed by its rotation. A gear device is provided at a proximal end of the screw pump, and the screw pump is rotationally driven by the gear device.

(52) <Accumulator **17**, T-Die **18**>

(53) The raw resin is extruded from a resin extrusion port of the cylinder **63a** and is injected into the accumulator **17** through the connecting pipe **15**. The accumulator **17** includes a cylinder **17a** and a piston **17b** slidable inside the cylinder, and molten resin **11a** can be stored in the cylinder **17a**. The piston **17b** is moved after a predetermined amount of the molten resin **11a** is stored in the cylinder **17a**, so that the molten resin **11a** is extruded and hung down from a slit provided in the T-die **18** through the connecting pipe **16** to form first and second resin sheets **p1**, **p2** in a molten state.

(54) 2-1-2. First and Second Split Molds **21**, **22**

(55) As illustrated in FIG. **11**, the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are led between the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. The first and second split molds **21**, **22** can be split at a parting surface where the

molds are in contact with each other when the molds are closed, and the molded body 5 is formed by the first and second split molds 21, 22. In other words, in a molding step, the molded body 5 is molded using a pair of the first and second split molds 21, 22 that can be split. In the embodiment, a skin material escape space sp (see FIG. 13) is also formed between the first and second split molds 21, 22. In the skin material escape space sp, an end portion of the skin material 4 is placed in the molding step.

(56) <First Split Mold 21>

(57) The first split mold 21 has a main body 21a1, a pair of first outer portions 21a2, and end face portions 21a3, as illustrated in FIG. 7, FIG. 8, FIG. 13, and FIG. 14. The main body 21a1 has a cavity cvt (see FIG. 12). When the first and second split molds 21, 22 are closed, the cavity cvt is a closed space formed between the first and second split molds 21, 22, and is a space in which a molded body is molded. The first outer portion 21a2 is connected to ends (left and right ends) of the main body 21a1 in a lateral width direction. In this regard, the lateral width direction is orthogonal to an opening and closing direction of the first and second split molds 21, 22 and is orthogonal to a vertical direction. The end face portion 21a3 has a surface against which the movable portion 23 is butted. In the embodiment, the end face portion 21a3 is a side surface of the first outer portion 21a2.

(58) The first split mold 21 is provided with a large number of decompression suction holes h1 (see FIG. 13), and the resin sheet p1 can be suctioned under reduced pressure to be formed into a shape along an inner surface 21b of the first split mold 21. In this regard, the inner surface 21b faces the cavity cvt.

(59) The first split mold 21 includes a pinch-off portion 21d, and the pinch-off portion 21d surrounds the cavity cvt. The pinch-off portion 21d is a projection formed to protrude from the side of the first split mold 21 to the side of the second split mold 22. The pinch-off portion 21d has an inner pinch-off portion 21d1 and an outer pinch-off portion 21d2. As illustrated in FIG. 13, the inner pinch-off portion 21d1 and the outer pinch-off portion 21d2 are formed in the first outer portion 21a2.

(60) The inner pinch-off portion 21d1 faces the cavity cvt. The inner pinch-off portion 21d1 is formed in a shape corresponding to the shape of the resin panel 1. Specifically, in the embodiment, the inner pinch-off portion 21d1 has a top portion, and a surface of the top portion is flat. In the embodiment, the inner pinch-off portion 21d1 extends in a line having straight lines connected with each other at bent points.

(61) The outer pinch-off portion 21d2 is located further away from the cavity cvt than the inner pinch-off portion 21d1. The outer pinch-off portion 21d2 is shaped to match a shape of the movable portion 23. Specifically, the outer pinch-off portion 21d2 is formed to match a shape of the engaging portion 23d (see FIG. 8) of the movable portion 23 that is closest to the first split mold 21 (hereinafter referred to as the closest engaging portion 23d), which will be described later. The outer pinch-off portion 21d2 is formed so that when the first split mold 21 and the movable portion 23 are viewed in plan view (when the first split mold 21 and the movable portion 23 are viewed from the direction of arrow C2 in FIG. 11), the outer pinch-off portion 21d2 matches the closest engaging portion 23d. In other words, the outer pinch-off portion 21d2 is formed parallel to the closest engaging portion 23d when the first split mold 21 and the movable portion 23 are viewed in plan view. This avoids distorting a cutting line of a burr portion and prevents the burr portion from being difficult to cut.

(62) In this regard, the embodiment is described as if the closest engaging portion 23d is located at the end of an opposing surface portion 23a of the movable portion 23, which is described below, but is not limited thereto. In the drive direction of the movable portion 23, the closest engaging portion 23d may be positioned at an inner position than the end in the opposing surface portion 23a.

(63) A surface of a top portion of the outer pinch-off portion 21d2 coincides with a surface of a top

portion of this closest engaging portion **23d**. In other words, if the surface of the top portion of the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** were extended, the extended surface would overlap with the surface of the top portion of the closest engaging portion **23d**. Therefore, the surface of the top portion of the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** smoothly connects to the surface of the top portion of the closest engaging portion **23d**. Thus, in the embodiment, the cutting line of the burr portion is further effectively avoided from being distorted, and the burr portion is effectively prevented from being difficult to cut.

(64) In this regard, in the embodiment, the shape of the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** corresponds to the closest engaging portion **23d**, and thus the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is parallel to the inner pinch-off portion **21d1**. However, the shape of the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** need not be limited to the shape of the inner pinch-off portion **21d1**. In other words, the shape of the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** can be defined according to the shape of the movable portion **23**. In other words, the shape of the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** is limited by the shape of the resin panel **1**, while the shape of the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is not limited by the shape of the resin panel **1**, but can be adapted to the shape of the movable portion **23**.

(65) The first split mold **21** includes a male projection **21e**. The male projection **21e** is provided at a position facing a female projection **19c** of the insertion apparatus **19** which is described later. The male projection **21e** can be slid with respect to the first split mold **21** to be accommodated in the first split mold **21**.

(66) <Second Split Mold **22**>

(67) The second split mold **22** has a main body **22a1**, a pair of second outer portions **22a2**, and a pair of opposing portions **22a3**, as illustrated in FIG. **13**. The main body **22a1** has a cavity cvt (see FIG. **12**). The second outer portion **22a2** is connected to ends (i.e. left and right ends) of the main body **22a1** in the lateral width direction. Each opposing portion **22a3** is connected to end of each second outer portion **22a2** in the lateral width direction. The opposing portion **22a3** is positioned to oppose the movable portion **23**.

(68) The second split mold **22** is provided with a large number of decompression suction holes h1 (see FIG. **13**), and the resin sheet p2 can be suctioned under reduced pressure to be formed into a shape along an inner surface **22b** of the second split mold **22**. In this regard, the inner surface **22b** faces the cavity cvt.

(69) The second split mold **22** includes a pinch-off portion **22d**, and the pinch-off portion **22d** surrounds the cavity cvt. The pinch-off portion **22d** is a projection formed to protrude from the side of the second split mold **22** to the side of the first split mold **21**. The pinch-off portion **22d** has an inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and an outer pinch-off portion **22d2**. As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** are formed in the second outer portion **22a2**.

(70) The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** are similar to the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** and outer pinch-off portion **21d2**, respectively.

(71) The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** faces the cavity cvt. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** is formed in a shape corresponding to the shape of the resin panel **1**. Specifically, the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** has a top portion, and a surface of the top portion is flat. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** extends in a line having straight lines connected with each other at bent points.

(72) The outer pinch-off portion **22d2** is located further away from the cavity cvt than the inner pinch-off portion **22d1**. Similar to the outer pinch-off portion **21d2**, the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** is shaped to match the shape of the movable portion **23**. A surface of a top portion of the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** coincides with the surface of the top portion of this closest engaging portion **23d**. Therefore, the surface of the top portion of the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** smoothly connects to the surface of the top portion of the closest engaging portion **23d**.

(73) <Skin Material Escape Space sp>

(74) The skin material escape space sp is space where a redundant portion of the skin material **4** is

placed. The skin material escape space sp is also space where an end portion of the skin material **4** is placed. The skin material escape space sp is formed between the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. Specifically, the skin material escape space sp is space between the first outer portion **21a2** and the second outer portion **22a2**, and is space between the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** and the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2**. (75) The skin material **4** used in the molding step is larger than the size of the cavity cvt. Therefore, a part of the skin material **4** becomes the redundant portion during the molding step. In this regard, the redundant portion of the skin material **4** is cut off by the operator in a subsequent step. The raw material resin **11** forming the burr portion can be reused, but if the redundant portion of the skin material **4** adheres to the resin sheet p1 corresponding to the raw material resin **11**, the redundant portion may become firmly bonded to the resin sheet p1, making it difficult to peel off the skin material **4** from the resin sheet p1. If the burr portion cannot be peeled off, the burr portion is discarded and the resin thereof cannot be reused. Therefore, in the embodiment, the skin material escape space sp is provided with the first and second split molds **21**, **22**.

(76) In the case where the thickness of the resin sheet p1 and the thickness of the resin sheet p2 are within a range from 0.6 (mm) to 1.7 (mm), respectively, a width dimension w1 of the skin material escape space sp and a depth dimension w2 of the skin material escape space sp shown in FIG. **13** are explained herein.

(77) The width dimension w1 is preferably set to 15.0, 15.5, 16.0, 16.5, 17.0, 17.5, 18.0, 18.5, 19.0, 19.5, 20.0, 20.5, 21.0, 21.5, 22.0, 22.5, 23.0, 23.5, 24.0, 24.5, 25.0 (mm). The width dimension w1 may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified herein.

(78) The depth direction w2 of the skin material escape space sp is preferably set to 4.0, 4.2, 4.4, 4.6, 4.8, 5.0, 5.2, 5.4, 5.6, 5.8, 6.0, 6.2, 6.4, 6.6, 6.8, 7.0, 7.2, 7.4, 7.6, 7.8, 8.0 (mm), and the depth dimension w2 may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified herein.

(79) By setting the width dimension w1 of the skin material escape space sp and the depth dimension w2 of the skin material escape space sp in this manner, adhesion between the skin material **4** and the resin sheet p1 can be suppressed.

(80) The first outer portion **21a2** is not provided with the decompression suction holes h1. In other words, although the decompression suction holes h1 are formed to communicate the cavity cvt of the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, the decompression suction holes h1 are not provided in the first outer portion **21a2**. This effectively suppresses adhesion of the skin material **4** and the resin sheet p1. In this regard, in the embodiment, the second outer portion **22a2** is described as being provided with the decompression suction holes h1, but it is not limited thereto and may not be provided.

(81) 2-1-3. Configuration of Movable Portion **23**

(82) The movable portion **23** has the function of engaging the burr portion and cutting the burr portion. The movable portion **23** is movable relative to the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. As illustrated in FIG. **9A** to FIG. **10B**, and FIG. **13**, the movable portion **23** is provided on the side of the first outer portion **21a2** of the first split mold **21**. The movable portion **23** has the opposing surface portion **23a**, a butting surface portion **23b**, a suction part **23c**, the engaging portion **23d**, and a sealing member **23e**.

(83) As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the opposing surface portion **23a** is provided to opposite the opposing portion **22a3** of the second split mold **22**. The opposing surface portion **23a** has a plurality of the engaging portions **23d**.

(84) As illustrated in FIG. **14**, the butting surface portion **23b** is formed to be able to butt against the end face portion **21a3** of the first split mold **21**. The butting surface portion **23b** is formed along the end face portion **21a3**. Therefore, when reduced pressure is generated by sucking air through the decompression suction hole h1 with the butting surface portion **23b** butting against the end face portion **21a3**, it is possible to prevent air from flowing from a gap between the butting surface portion **23b** and the end face portion **21a3** into space where resin is to be shaped. In this regard, the

space where the resin is to be shaped is, for example, the cavity cvt, the gap between the burr portion and the surface of the engaging portion **23d**, and the like.

(85) As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the suction part **23c** is a hole formed in the opposing surface portion **23a** and opens to an area where engaging portion **23d** is formed. When reduced pressure is generated by sucking air through the suction part **23c**, the burr portion (an outer burr portion **5bc2**) is shaped along the engaging portion **23d**. This allows the burr portion (the outer burr portion **5bc2**) to more securely hook onto the movable portion **23** and prevents the burr portion from sliding against the movable portion **23** when the movable portion **23** is moved. As a result, in the embodiment, when the movable portion **23** is moved, the burr portion follows the movable portion **23** properly and the burr portion can be cut more reliably.

(86) For example, if reduced pressure is generated with the suction part **23c** when the resin sheet **p1** is being shaped in the cavity cvt, wrinkles or the like may occur in the resin sheet **p1** and the formability may be degraded. Therefore, a decompression suction system in the suction part **23c** is independent of a decompression suction system of the decompression suction holes **h1** of the first split mold **21**. This makes it possible to separately control timing at which the suction part **23c** performs decompression suction and timing at which the decompression suction hole **h1** performs decompression suction, thereby avoiding loss of formability.

(87) The engaging portion **23d** has the function for engaging with the burr portion. The engaging portion **23d** is a protrusion formed to project toward the second split mold **22**. Since a plurality of the engaging portions **23d** are formed on the opposing surface portion **23a**, the opposing surface portion **23a** has an uneven shape in the region where the engaging portions **23d** are formed. In this regard, the embodiment is described as if the suction part **23c** is open in the opposing surface portion **23a** in the area between two adjacent engaging portions **23d**, but is not limited to this. The suction part **23c** may be open on the surface of the engaging portion **23d**.

(88) As illustrated in FIG. **9B**, the sealing member **23e** is attached to the butting surface portion **23b**. Specifically, a groove is formed in the butting surface portion **23b**, and the sealing member **23e** is attached within the groove. This effectively prevents air from flowing from between the butting surface portion **23b** and the end face portion **21a3** into space where the resin described above is to be shaped. In this regard, although the embodiment describes the sealing member **23e** as being attached to the butting surface portion **23b**, it is not limited to this, and the sealing member **23e** may be attached to the end face portion **21a3** of the first split mold **21**.

(89) 2-1-4. Configuration of Drive Mechanism **24**

(90) As illustrated in FIG. **5**, the drive mechanism **24** is located at a rear face of the first split mold **21**. The drive mechanism **24** is configured to move the movable portion **23**. The drive mechanism **24** has a pair of upper drive mechanisms **24a** and a pair of lower drive mechanisms **24b**, as illustrated in FIG. **5**. Each upper drive mechanism **24a** and each lower drive mechanism **24b** can be configured of cylinders, for example. Each upper drive mechanism **24a** and each lower drive mechanism **24b** are provided across the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23**, and each upper drive mechanism **24a** and each lower drive mechanism **24b** are fixed to the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23**. The cylinder of each upper drive mechanism **24a** and the cylinder of each lower drive mechanism **24b** are extended to move the movable portion **23**.

(91) Each upper drive mechanism **24a** and each lower drive mechanism **24b** can be controlled independently. Thus, the drive mechanism **24** can move the upper part of the movable portion **23** and then move the lower part of the movable portion **23**, as illustrated in FIGS. **10A** and **10B**. This allows the force to tear the burr portion to be localized, and the movable portion **23** can tear the burr portion smoothly.

(92) 2-1-5. Insertion Apparatus **19**

(93) The insertion apparatus **19** is movable by a drive mechanism not shown in the figure. As illustrated in FIG. **4A**, the insertion apparatus **19** has a base **19a**, suction pads **19b**, and female projections **19c**. Each component is held by the base **9a**. The suction pad **9b** is used to suction and

hold the core member **3**. The female projection **19c** can hold the skin material **4** and is used to attach the skin material **4** to the first split mold **21**.

(94) 2-2. Molded Body **5**

(95) The resin panel **1** is obtained by removing the burr portion of the molded body **5** (see FIG. **15**), which is described below. In other words, the molded body **5** is a molded body after being molded in the molding step but before the burr portion is removed.

(96) As illustrated in FIG. **15**, the molded body **5** includes a molded main body **5a** and a large burr portion **5b** such that the molded main body **5a** and the large burr portion **5b** are connected to each other via a cutting line **5c** surrounding the molded main body **5a**. The cutting line **5c** corresponds to a portion squashed by the pinch-off portions **21d**, **22d**. By cutting the molded body **5** along the cutting line **5c** around the entire circumference of the molded main body **5a**, the molded body **5** can be separated into the molded main body **5a** and the large burr portion **5b**.

(97) As illustrated in FIG. **15** and FIG. **16**, the molded main body **5a** includes a portion corresponding to the resin panel **1** described earlier (a molded member **5d**), and a small burr portion **5e** and an inner burr portion **5bc1** that are connected to the corresponding portion. In other words, the resin panel **1** can be obtained by removing the small burr portion **5e** and the inner burr portion **5bc1** from the molded main body **5a**.

(98) The large burr portion **5b** also includes an upper burr portion **5bu** located above the molded main body **5a**, a lower burr portion **5bb** located below the molded main body **5a**, and the outer burr portion **5bc2** located between the upper burr portion **5bu** and the lower burr portion **5bb**. The outer burr portion **5bc2** is connected to the inner burr portion **5bc1** before being cut by the movable portion **23**.

(99) As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the inner burr portion **5bc1** consists of the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** and the skin material **4**. On the other hand, the outer burr portion **5bc2** consists of the resin sheets **p1**, **p2**. In other words, the outer burr portion **5bc2** does not include the skin material **4**. In other words, the skin material **4** is arranged so that the edge of the skin material **4** is positioned between the inner pinch-off portions **21d1**, **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2**.

(100) The cutting line **5c** includes a left line **5cl** (an example of an outer line portion), a right line **5cr** (an example of the outer line portion), an upper line **5cu**, and a bottom line **5cb**. The left line **5cl**, the right line **5cr**, the upper line **5cu**, and the bottom line **5cb** are located on a left side, a right side, an upper side, and a lower side of the molded main body **5a**, respectively, when the molded body **5** is viewed from a mold closing direction (direction along an arrow **C2** in FIG. **11**) of the second split mold **22** illustrated in FIG. **11**.

(101) The embodiment includes a first cutting step in which the molded body **5** is cut along the right line **5cr** and the left line **5cl** by the first and second split molds **21**, **22** and the movable portion **23**. Then, after the molded body **5** is removed from the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, a second cutting step is performed to cut the molded body **5** along the remainder of the cutting line **5c** (i.e., the upper line **5cu** and the bottom line **5cb**).

(102) The molded main body **5a** consists of the molded member **5d** (corresponding to the resin panel **1**), the small burr portion **5e**, and the inner burr portion **5bc1** connected via a parting line **5f**. In other words, the molded main body **5a** has the molded member **5d**, the small burr portion **5e** and the inner burr portion **5bc1**, and a part of the parting line **5f** (a left line **5fl** and a right line **5fr**). Therefore, the small burr portion **5e** and the inner burr portion **5bc1** can be separated from the molded member **5d** by cutting the molded main body **5a** along the parting line **5f** all the way around the molded member **5d**.

(103) The parting line **5f** has the left line **5fl** (an example of an inner line portion), the right line **5fr** (an example of the inner line portion), an upper line **5fu**, and a bottom line **5fb**. The left line **5fl**, the right line **5fr**, the upper line **5fu**, and the bottom line **5fb** are located on the left side, the right side, the upper side, and the lower side of the molded main body **5a**, respectively, when the molded body **5** is viewed from the mold closing direction (arrow **C2**) of the second split mold **22** illustrated in

FIG. 11.

(104) In this regard, in the embodiment, the bottom line 5cb of the cutting line 5c overlaps the bottom line 5fb of the parting line 5f.

(105) The upper line 5cu of the cutting line 5c is located adjacent to a top portion of the upper line 5fu of the parting line 5f. Therefore, the molded member 5d and the small burr portion 5e are connected via the upper line 5fu.

(106) Furthermore, the left line 5cl and the right line 5cr of the cutting line 5c are located adjacent to lateral sides of the left line 5fl and the right line 5fr of the parting line 5f, respectively. Therefore, the molded member 5d and the inner burr portion 5bc1 are connected via the left line 5fl and the right line 5fr.

(107) The upper line 5fu of the parting line 5f is not straight. This makes it necessary, for example, for the operator to cut the molded body 5 along the upper line 5fu using a cutter. Therefore, in the embodiment, the upper line 5cu formed in a straight line is provided adjacent to an upper side of the upper line 5fu. In the embodiment, the bottom line 5fb of the parting line 5f is also straight. These straight lines can be cut by using a cutter of a burr portion cutting device. Thus, after the left line 5cl and the right line 5cr are cut, the upper line 5cu and the bottom line 5cb are cut, and then the molded main body 5a is separated from the large burr portion 5b.

(108) 2-3. Description of Each Step of the Manufacturing Method

(109) The manufacturing method of the resin panel 1 of this embodiment includes a skin material attachment step, a hanging step, a resin sheet shaping step, a core member welding step, the molding step, an engagement step, the first cutting step, a molded body removal step, the second cutting step, and a post-process.

(110) 2-3-1. Skin Material Attachment Step

(111) In the skin material attachment step, the skin material 4 is attached to the first split mold 21. Specifically, the female projection 19c is inserted in advance into a through-hole formed in the skin material 4, and the skin material 4 is held by the insertion apparatus 19, as illustrated in FIG. 3. In the skin material attachment step, the female projection 19c and the male projection 21e are made to face each other, then both are engaged, and in this state, the skin material 4 is moved to the male projection 21e by pushing the skin material 4 toward the male projection 21e. As a result, the skin material 4 is attached to the first split mold 21, as illustrated in FIG. 11.

(112) 2-3-2. Hanging Step

(113) In the hanging step, as illustrated in FIG. 11, the resin sheets p1, p2 extruded from the T-die 18 are hung between the first and second split molds 21, 22. The resin sheet p1 is hung between the core member 3 and the skin material 4. The resin sheet p2 is hung between the insertion apparatus 19 and the second split mold 22. In the embodiment, direct vacuum molding is performed using the resin sheets p1, p2 as they are extruded from the T-die 18, so the resin sheets p1, p2 are not cooled to room temperature and solidified before molding, and the solidified resin sheets p1, p2 are not heated before molding.

(114) 2-3-3. Resin Sheet Shaping Step

(115) In the resin sheet shaping step, the resin sheet p1 and a protruding portion (e.g., the pinch-off portion) of the first split mold 21 are made to closely contact in advance, and a closed space is formed between the resin sheet p1 and the first split mold 21. The same applies to the resin sheet p2 and the second split mold 22. In this regard, to form the closed space, an outer frame (not shown) that is separate from the first and second split molds 21, 22 can be used. Each outer frame is placed around the periphery of the first and second split molds 21, 22. Each outer frame is movable in the opening and closing direction of the first and second split molds 21, 22, and is provided with decompression suction holes. The outer frame of the first split mold 21 closely contacts the resin sheet p1 by suctioning it, and the closed space is formed between the first split mold 21, the resin sheet p1 and the outer frame. The same is applied to the outer frame of the second split mold 22.

(116) In the resin sheet shaping step, air in the closed space is suctioned to generate reduced

pressure through the decompression suction holes **h1** of the first and second split molds **21** and **22**, and the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are shaped along the first and second split molds **21** and **22**. In the first split mold **21**, the resin sheet **p1** is shaped to follow the shape of the inner surface **21b** of the cavity. The resin sheet **p2** is shaped to follow the inner surface **22b** of the cavity. The timing for shaping the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** may be different from each other. For example, the resin sheet **p2** may be shaped after the core member welding step, or the resin sheet **p2** may be shaped during a mold clamping step.

(117) In this regard, no decompression suction holes **h1** are formed in the first outer portion **21a2**. Therefore, even if the resin sheet shaping step is performed, adhesion between the skin material **4** and the resin sheet **p1** is suppressed. Therefore, when the inner burr portion **5bc1** is removed from the molded body main body **5a**, the resin of the inner burr portion **5bc1** can be reused.

(118) 2-3-4. Core Member Welding Step

(119) In the core member welding step, the core member **3** is welded to the resin sheet **p1**. As illustrated in FIG. **11**, the insertion apparatus **19** lets the skin material **4** be attached to the first split mold **21**, thereby leaving the core member **3** in the insertion apparatus **19**. In this state, the core member **3** can be welded to the resin sheet **p1** by moving the insertion apparatus **19** toward the resin sheet **p1**. After the core member **3** is welded to the resin sheet **p1**, the insertion apparatus **19** is moved to a position outside movement paths of the first and second split molds **21**, **22**.

(120) The timing for placing the core member **3** between the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** is not limited, and the core member **3** may be placed between the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** during the hanging step or the shaping step. The core member **3** may be welded to the resin sheet **p2** first.

(121) 2-3-5. Molding Step

(122) In the molding step, the first and second split molds **21**, **22** are closed by moving them in the direction of arrows **C1**, **C2** in FIG. **11**. As a result, the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are squashed and welded together in the area corresponding to the pinch-off portion **21d** and the pinch-off portion **22d** to form the molded body **5** illustrated in FIG. **15**.

(123) 2-3-6. Engaging Step (Burr Portion Shaping Step)

(124) In the engaging step, the outer burr portion **5bc2** of the molded body **5** is shaped along the movable portion **23** and the outer burr portion **5bc2** is engaged with the movable portion **23** (burr portion shaping step). In other words, in the engaging step, as illustrated in FIG. **13**, the outer burr portion **5bc2** is suctioned towards the engaging portion **23d** via the suction part **23c**, so that the outer burr portion **5bc2** of the resin sheet **p1** is shaped along the engaging portion **23d**.

(125) In this regard, with the first and second split molds **21**, **22** closed in the molding step, the resin (i.e. the resin sheets **p1**, **p2**) forming the outer burr portion **5bc2** are welded to each other (see FIG. **13**). In this state, the engaging step (the burr portion shaping step) is performed, which causes the non-welded portions of the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** to be easily spaced apart, and as a result, the outer burr portion **5bc2** is made hollow. As a result, even if the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are thin, the outer burr portion **5bc2** (of the resin sheet **p1**) will have clearly formed unevenness along the engaging portion **23d**, and the engaging portion **23d** will easily catch the outer burr portion **5bc2** (of the resin sheet **p1**). As a result, the movable portion **23** can effectively tear the outer burr portion **5bc2** from the inner burr portion **5bc1**.

(126) As mentioned above, the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** constituting the outer burr portion **5bc2** are welded together. This increases the rigidity of the outer burr portion **5bc2**, and as a result, the force of the engaging portion **23d** pulling the outer burr portion **5bc2** is more easily transmitted to the outer burr portion **5bc2**, making it easier to tear the outer burr portion **5bc2** from the inner burr portion **5bc1**.

(127) 2-3-7. First Cutting Step

(128) After the engaging step, the molded main body **5a** has been accommodated in the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, and the large burr portion **5b** has been engaged with the engaging portion **23d** provided in the movable portion **23** of the first split mold **21**. In this state, as illustrated

in FIG. 10a, when an upper side of the movable portion 23 is tilted away from the main body 22a1, the molded body 5 begins to be cut from its upper side along the left line 5cl and the right line 5cr of the cutting line 5c. Next, as illustrated in FIG. 10B, when the movable portion 23 is moved so that the lower side of the movable portion 23 is away from the first split mold 21, the tear of the molded body 5 proceeds downward and afterwards the first cutting step is completed (see FIG. 15).

(129) 2-3-8. Molded Body Removal Step

(130) In the molded body removal step, the first and second split molds 21, 22 are opened while the burr portions, such as the upper burr portion 5bu for example, are clamped by a clamping device, which is not shown in the figure. The molded body 5 is then transported by the clamping device to a desired location for implementing the next step. As illustrated in FIG. 16, the molded body 5 is cut along the left line 5cl and the right line 5cr of the cutting line 5c.

(131) On the other hand, the molded body 5 is not cut along the upper line 5cu and the bottom line 5cb of the cutting line 5c. If the molded body 5 were cut along any of the upper line 5cu and the bottom line 5cb, the molded main body 5a would tend to swing against the large burr portion 5b, making it difficult to handle. However, in the embodiment, the molded body 5 is easy to handle because the molded body 5 is cut along only the left line 5cl and right line 5cr at this stage.

(132) 2-3-9. Second Cutting Step

(133) In the second cutting step, the molded body 5 is separated into the molded main body 5a and the large burr portion 5b by cutting the molded body 5 along the upper line 5cu and the bottom line 5cb. A cutting device can be used for the second cutting step, and the cutting device can, for example, detect positions of the upper line 5cu and the bottom line 5cb and automatically cut the cutting line.

(134) 2-3-10. Post Process

(135) In the post process, the small burr portion 5e and the inner burr portions 5bc1 are removed to obtain the resin panel 1. This process can be performed by an operator.

3. Effects of the Embodiment

(136) 3-1. Decompression and Suction Function of Movable Portion 23

(137) In the engaging step (the burr portion shaping step) in the embodiment, the outer burr portion 5bc2 is sucked onto the engaging portion 23d of the movable portion 23 using the suction part 23c. As a result, the outer burr portion 5bc2 is shaped along the movable portion 23, and the outer burr portion 5bc2 is more securely engaged with the movable portion 23. Therefore, when the movable portion 23 is moved relative to the first and second split molds 21, 22, the outer burr portion 5bc2 is prevented from sliding against the movable portion 23, and the outer burr portion 5bc2 moves to follow the movable portion 23. As a result, the outer burr portion 5bc2 is more securely cut from the molded main body 5a.

(138) 3-2. Double Pinch-Off Portion

(139) In the embodiment, the first and second split molds 21, 22 have a double pinch-off structure. That is, the first and second split molds 21, 22 have the inner pinch-off portions 21d1, 22d1 connected to the cavity cvt, and the outer pinch-off portions 21d2, 22d2 provided at positions farther from the cavity cvt than the inner pinch-off portions 21d1, 22d1, respectively. Here, the inner pinch-off portions 21d1, 22d1 must be shaped to correspond to the shape of the molded main body 5a. On the other hand, the outer pinch-off portions 21d2, 22d2 are positioned to demarcate the inner burr portion 5bc1 and the outer burr portion 5bc2. The inner burr portion 5bc1 and the outer burr portion 5bc2 are both to be cut and are unnecessary for the product. In other words, the outer pinch-off portions 21d2, 22d2 are not connected to the cavity cvt, and they demarcate the inner burr portion 5bc1 and the outer burr portion 5bc2, which are unnecessary for the product. Therefore, the outer pinch-off portions 21d2, 22d2 are not subject to the same restrictions as the inner pinch-off portions 21d1, 22d1, such as conforming to the shape of the molded main body 5a. Therefore, in the embodiment, the shape of the outer pinch-off portions 21d2, 22d2 can be easily set to a shape that takes into account the connection with the movable portion 23. In other words,

the cutting line of the burr portions can be avoided from being distorted, and the burr portions can be restrained from being difficult to cut.

(140) In the embodiment, each of the inner pinch-off portions **21d1**, **22d1** is described as having a flat surface at its top portion, but is not limited to this. The inner pinch-off portions **21d1**, **22d1** may extend so that the surfaces of their top portions are uneven (wavy). In describing the shape of such inner pinch-off portions **21d1**, **22d1**, a resin panel of a different shape than the resin panel described in the embodiment is used as an example. That is, the resin panel may be, for example, a hinge formed of a resin sheet squashed by a mold between two base bodies **3a**, **3b** covered with the resin sheet. Here, the hinge is a thin-walled portion formed of the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** squashed by pinch-off portions **21dd**, **22dd** (see FIG. 19) of the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, and the resin panel can be bent at this hinge. The hinge is formed so that the hinge is closer to one side of the resin panel in the thickness direction. In this form of the resin panel, a parting line in the base bodies **3a**, **3b** is formed at the center of the resin panel in the thickness direction, whereas a parting line in the hinge is the hinge itself, which is closer to one side of the resin panel in the thickness direction. In other words, the parting line of the resin panel has a portion having a complicated structure and connecting the base bodies **3a**, **3b** and the hinge. In other words, to produce such a resin panel, the pinch-off portions **21d**, **22d** of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** have a complicated structure. Specifically, as illustrated in FIG. 19, in the cross section of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** at a position of the hinge, the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** has a projecting portion and the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** has a recessed portion.

(141) This embodiment is suitable for resin panels having such a hinge. If a resin panel having the above-described hinge is manufactured with a conventional mold that is not provided with the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2**, the cutting line of the burr portions at the hinge will be distorted, and mold design will be complicated. In contrast, in the embodiment, the shape of the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2** can be determined without being restricted by the shape of the inner pinch-off portions **21d1**, **22d1**. Therefore, in the embodiment, the cutting line of the burr portions can be avoided from being distorted, and the burr portions can be prevented from being difficult to cut. In addition, since configurations of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** can be avoided from becoming intricate and complicated, it is easier to design the mold.

(142) In the conventional manufacturing method, the movable portion is configured to cut a portion corresponding to a connecting area between the molded main body **5a** and the inner burr portion **5bc1** in the embodiment. In such a manufacturing method, if the portion is not cut completely, the resin sheet may peel off or turn over from the portion when the molded main body is taken out from the mold, resulting in a defective molded main body. Since the embodiment is configured to cut the connecting portion between the inner burr portion **5bc1** and the outer burr portion **5bc2**, even if the outer burr portion **5bc2** cannot be completely cut from the inner burr portion **5bc1**, the location where the peeling or turning over occurs is in the unwanted inner burr portion **5bc1**. Therefore, the embodiment can avoid the molded main body from becoming defective, and the yield rate can be improved. In addition, as mentioned above, since the embodiment employs the double pinch-off structure, the burr portion itself is less likely to be cut, further increasing the effectiveness of the yield improvement.

(143) A movable portion in conventional manufacturing methods also cuts a skin material. Here, even if a resin sheet can be cut, the skin material may not be cut. In such cases, when a molded main body is removed from a mold, the skin material may peel off from a part of the skin material that could not be cut, resulting in a defective molded main body.

(144) In the embodiment, since the edge of the skin material **4** is inside the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2**, the movable portion **23** is not configured to cut the skin material **4** itself. Therefore, the embodiment can avoid the molded main body **5a** from becoming defective, and the yield rate can be improved.

(145) In the case where the skin material **4** extends to the outer burr portion **5bc2**, even if the skin

material **4** is not cut by the movable portion **23**, the part where peeling occurs is the unnecessary inner burr portion **5bc1**. In other words, because the embodiment employs a double pinch-off structure, even if the skin material **4** extends to the outer burr portion **5bc2**, the molded main body can avoid becoming defective and the yield rate can be improved.

4 Modifications

(146) 4-1 First Modification

(147) As shown in FIG. **17**, even if the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2** described in the embodiment are not provided in the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, the effect of the decompression suction function of the movable portion **23** described in the embodiments can be obtained. In other words, even in the embodiment shown in FIG. **17**, the outer burr portion **5bc2** is more securely engaged with the movable portion **23** and the outer burr portion **5bc2** is more securely cut from the molded main body **5a**.

(148) In this First Modification, the outer pinch-off portions **21d2**, **22d2** are not provided in the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, so as shown in FIG. **18**, the inner burr portion **5bc1** and the outer burr portion **5bc2** are not cut in the cutting process, and the inner burr portion **5bc1** is cut from the molded main body **5a**. At this time, since the decompression suction holes **h1** are not formed in the first outer portion **21a2**, adhesion of the resin sheet **p1** and the skin material **4** is inhibited, and even if the movable portion **23** is driven, the skin material **4** is avoided being cut together with the burr portions. Therefore, when the resin is reused, it is possible to avoid the time and effort required to peel the skin material **4** from joined portions consisting of the cut inner burr portion **5bc1** and the cut outer burr portion **5bc2**.

(149) 4-2 Second Modification

(150) The first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** are connected via the drive mechanism **24**. Here, if a stroke of the drive mechanism **24** is large, or depending on the structure of the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23**, the movable portion **23** may drop out of the first split mold **21**, making it difficult for the movable portion **23** to return to the initial position. For example, if the stroke of the drive mechanism **24** is large, the movable portion **23** loses contact with the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** drops out of the first split mold **21**.

(151) At this time, since the movable portion **23** is connected to the first split mold **21** via the drive mechanism **24**, the movable portion **23** does not fall to the floor. However, when the drive mechanism **24** is driven to return the movable portion **23** to its original initial position, the movable portion **23** may interfere with the side of the first split mold **21**, making it impossible to return the movable portion **23** to its initial position. In such a case, for example, the operator will need to move the movable portion **23** to the initial position each time it is dropped out.

(152) In this Second Modification, as illustrated in FIG. **20A** and FIG. **20B**, the first split mold **21** has a supporting portion **21f** and the movable portion **23** has a supported portion **23f**. In this regard, in FIG. **20A** and FIG. **20B**, the drive mechanism **24** is omitted.

(153) The supporting portion **21f** is configured to prevent the movable portion **23** from falling out of the first split mold **21**. The supporting portion **21f** is formed to project from the first split mold **21** in the direction toward the movable portion **23**. The supporting portion **21f** is connected to a lateral side of the first split mold **21**. Specifically, in this modification, the supporting portion **21f** is connected to the first outer portion **21a2**. When the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** are viewed from the front side (viewed from the arrow **Ar** direction in FIG. **20A**), the supporting portion **21f** is provided to project toward the movable portion **23** than the end face portion **21a3** of the first split mold **21**. In other words, as viewed from the arrow **Ar** direction in FIG. **20A**, the supporting portion **21f** is provided to project toward the movable portion **23** than the outermost pinch-off portion (the outer pinch-off portion **21d2**) in the width direction. In the thickness direction **Dr** of the first split mold **21**, the supporting portion **21f** is located at the rear side of the first split mold **21** rather than at the front side of the first split mold **21**. Here, the front side of the first split mold **21** is, for example, the portion where the inner pinch-off portion **21d1**, the outer

pinch-off portion **21d2**, and the inner surface **21b** or the like are formed.

(154) The supported portion **23f** is configured to be supported by the supporting portion **21f**. The supported portion **23f** is a recess into which the supporting portion **21f** is inserted. As illustrated in FIG. **20C**, since the supporting portion **21f** is inserted into the supported portion **23f**, the supported portion **23f** is supported on the top surface of the supporting portion **21f** when the movable portion **23** is being driven. This prevents the movable portion **23** from falling out of the first split mold **21**.

(155) In this regard, since the movable portion **23** moves in a swinging manner as illustrated in FIG. **10A** and FIG. **10B**, the size of the supported portion **23f** is larger than that of the supporting portion **21f**. This avoids interference between the supporting portion **21f** and the supported portion **23f** when the movable portion **23** moves in the swinging manner, and thus the movable portion **23** moves smoothly.

(156) This Second Modification is also applicable to the First Modification.

Third Viewpoint

1. Resin Panel **1**

(157) In the third viewpoint, the structure of the resin panel **1** (an example of a “structure”) is the same as that of the resin panel **1** of the first and second viewpoints (see “1. Resin panel **1**” of the first and second viewpoints). Therefore, the description thereof is omitted.

2. Manufacturing Method of Resin Panel **1**

(158) 2-1. Description of the Manufacturing Device

(159) As illustrated in FIG. **21**, the manufacturing method of the embodiments uses the molding machine **10** and the insertion apparatus **19** to form the molded body **5** illustrated in FIG. **15**. As illustrated in FIG. **21** to FIG. **22**, the molding machine **10** is equipped with the pair of the sheet forming devices **14**, the mold (i.e. the first and second split molds **21**, **22**), outer frames **31**, **32**, and the movable portions **23**. In this regard, although not illustrated, the molding machine **10** is also equipped with a drive mechanism (not shown in the figure, refer to the drive mechanism **24** in FIG. **5**) that moves the movable portion **23** away from the first split mold **21** as illustrated in FIG. **25A** to FIG. **25C**. This drive mechanism is capable of moving an upper part of the movable portion **23** and then moving a lower part of the movable portion **23** as illustrated in FIG. **25B** and FIG. **25C** to smoothly tear off the burr portion (the part of the resin sheet).

(160) 2-1-1. Configuration of Sheet Forming Device **14**

(161) The sheet forming device **14** and resin used in the embodiment of the third viewpoint illustrated in FIG. **21** are the same as the sheet forming device **14** and the resin used in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints (see “2-1-1. Configuration of Sheet Forming Device **14**” in the first and second viewpoints). Therefore, the explanation is omitted.

(162) 2-1-2. Mold (First and Second Split Molds **21**, **22**) and Outer Frames **31**, **32**

(163) As illustrated in FIG. **26**, the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are led between the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. The first and second split molds **21**, **22** can be split at the parting surfaces that are in contact when these molds are closed, and the molded body **5** (see FIG. **15**) is formed by the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. In other words, in the molding step, the molded body **5** is molded using the pair of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** that can be split. In the embodiment, the skin material escape space **sp** (see FIG. **33** and FIG. **34**) is formed between the first and second split molds **21**, **22**. In the molding step, an end of the skin material **4** is placed in the skin material escape space **sp**.

(164) <First Split Mold **21**>

(165) The first split mold **21** has the main body **21a1**, the pair of the first outer portions **21a2**, and the end face portion **21a3** (see FIG. **34**), as illustrated in FIG. **24**. The main body **21a1** has the cavity **cvt**. When the first and second split molds **21**, **22** are closed, the cavity **cvt** is a closed space formed between the first and second split molds **21**, **22**, and is a space in which a molded body is formed. The first outer portion **21a2** is connected to the ends (left and right ends) of the main body **21a1** in the lateral width direction. In this regard, the lateral width direction is perpendicular to the

opening and closing direction of the first and second split molds **21**, **22** and perpendicular to the vertical direction. The end face portion **21a3** has a surface against which the movable portion **23** is butted. In the embodiment, the end face portion **21a3** is formed on each side surface of the first outer portion **21a2**.

(166) The first split mold **21** is provided with a large number of decompression suction holes **h1** (see FIG. **29**), and the resin sheet **p1** can be suctioned under reduced pressure to be formed into a shape along an inner surface **21b** of the first split mold **21**. In this regard, the inner surface **21b** faces the cavity **cvt** as illustrated in FIG. **24**.

(167) As illustrated in FIG. **24**, the first split mold **21** includes the pinch-off portion **21d**, which surrounds the cavity **cvt**. The pinch-off portion **21d** is a protrusion formed to project from the first split mold **21** side to the second split mold **22** side. As illustrated in FIG. **29**, the pinch-off portion **21d** has the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **21d2**. The inner pinch-off portion **21d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** are formed on the first outer portion **21a2**.

(168) The inner pinch-off portion **21d1** is provided so as to face the cavity **cvt**. The inner pinch-off portion **21d1** is formed in a shape corresponding to the shape of the resin panel **1**. Specifically, in the embodiment, the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** has a flat surface on the top face. In the embodiment, the inner pinch-off portion **21d1** extends in a line having straight lines connected with each other at bent points.

(169) The outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is located further away from the cavity **cvt** than the inner pinch-off portion **21d1**. The outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is shaped to match the shape of the movable portion **23**. Specifically, the outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is formed to match the shape of the engaging portion **23d** (see FIG. **24** to FIG. **25C**) of the movable portion **23** that is closest to the first split mold **21** (hereinafter referred to as the closest engaging portion **23d**), which will be described later. The outer pinch-off portion **21d2** is also formed to coincide with the closest engaging portion **23d** when the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** are viewed in plan view. This avoids distorting a cutting line of a burr portion and prevents the burr portion from being difficult to cut.

(170) As illustrated in FIG. **24**, the first split mold **21** has a pair of suction parts **21A**. The suction part **21A** is provided at each of the top and bottom of the first split mold **21**, respectively. The upper and lower suction parts **21A** are connected to the upper and lower ends of the main body **21a1**, respectively. The suction parts **21A** are formed so that the suction parts **21A** project from the first split mold **21** side toward the second split mold **22** side. As a result, when the first split mold **21** moves forward, the suction part **21A** contacts the resin sheet **p1** prior to the pinch-off portion **21d**. Suction holes **21B** are formed in the front edge portion of the suction part **21A**, and the suction part **21A** can suck the resin sheet **p1** by sucking air through the suction holes **21B**. As illustrated in FIG. **24**, a slope surface **21C** is formed on the suction part **21A**, so that the resin sheet **p1** can easily follow the surface of the first split mold **21** when the resin sheet **p1** is shaped along the first split mold **21**.

(171) The first split mold **21** includes a male projection **21e**, as illustrated in FIG. **21**. The male projection **21e** is provided at a position facing a female projection **19c** of the insertion apparatus **19** which is described later. The male projection **21e** can be slid with respect to the first split mold **21** to be accommodated in a hole (not shown in the figure) in the first split mold **21**.

(172) <Second Split Mold **22**>

(173) The second split mold **22** has the main body **22a1**, the pair of the second outer portions **22a2**, the pair of the opposing portions **22a3**, and four chamfer portions **22a4**, as illustrated in FIG. **22** and FIG. **23**. The main body **22a1** has the cavity **cvt**. The second outer portion **22a2** is connected to ends (i.e. left and right ends) of the main body **22a1** in the lateral width direction. Each opposing portion **22a3** is connected to end of each second outer portion **22a2** in the lateral width direction. The opposing portion **22a3** is positioned to oppose the engaging portion **23d** of the movable portion **23**. Each opposing portion **22a3** has a flat surface and is connected to top and bottom

chamfer portions **22a4** and one of left and right chamfer portions **22a4**.

(174) The chamfer portion **22a4** is formed on a periphery of the second split mold **22**. In the embodiment, the second split mold **22** is square in plan view, and correspondingly, the chamfer portions **22a4** are provided on each of four sides of the second split mold **22**. Each chamfer portion **22a4** has a front edge portion **22af** and a rear edge portion **22ab**. The front edge portion **22af** is the portion of the chamfer portion **22a4** closest to the first split mold **21** in the opening and closing direction of the mold. The rear edge portion **22ab** is the portion of the chamfer portion **22a4** that is farthest from the first split mold **21** in the opening and closing direction of the mold.

(175) The left and right chamfer portions **22a4** are located between the outer frame **32** and the pinch-off portion (outer pinch-off portion **22d2**). When looking at the left and right chamfer portions **22a4** when the resin sheet **p2** is hanging, the distance between the left and right chamfer portions **22a4** and the hanging resin sheet **p2** increases as the position advances from the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** to the outer frame **32**. In the embodiment, each chamfer portion **22a4** is configured as a tapered surface (a slope surface). Specifically, the tapered surface (the slope surface) of the chamfer portion **22a4** is formed from the front edge portion **22af** to the rear edge portion **22ab**. In this regard, no suction holes for suctioning the resin sheet **p2** are formed in the chamfer portion **22a4**.

(176) As illustrated in FIG. **29**, a slope angle θ of the tapered surface of the chamfer portion **22a4** is preferably greater than 0 degrees and equal to or less than 60 degrees. Specifically, for example, the slope angle θ (degrees) is 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, or 60. The slope angle θ can also be defined within a range between any two of the values exemplified here (e.g., within a range from 5 degrees to 60 degrees).

(177) As illustrated in FIG. **29**, a width **w1** of the chamfer portion **22a4** in the opening and closing direction of the mold is within a range from 10 mm to 63 mm, preferably. Specifically, for example, the width **w1** (mm) is 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, or 63, and can also be defined within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(178) As illustrated in FIG. **29**, a width **w2** of the chamfer portion **22a4** in the direction from the pinch-off portion **22d** to the outer frame **31, 32** is within a range from 5.7 mm to 70 mm, preferably. More preferably, the width **w2** is within a range from 12 mm to 40 mm. Specifically, for example, the width **w2** (mm) is 5.7, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 26, 28, 30, 32, 34, 36, 38, 40, 42, 44, 46, 48, 50, 52, 54, 56, 58, 60, 62, 64, 66, 68, or 70, and can also be defined within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(179) In the embodiment, the second split mold **22** has a total of four chamfer portions **22a4** (the upper and lower chamfer portions **22a4** and the left and right chamfer portions **22a4**). The configurations of these chamfer portions **22a4** (slope angle θ , width **w1**, and width **w2**) may be the same or different from each other as long as they satisfy the numerical values or the numerical ranges described above. For example, the configurations of the upper and lower chamfer portions **22a4** are the same as each other and the configurations of the left and right chamfer portions **22a4** are the same as each other, but the configuration of the upper and lower chamfer portions **22a4** may be different from the configuration of the left and right chamfer portions **22a4**.

(180) The second split mold **22** is provided with the large number of decompression suction holes **h1** (see FIG. **29**), and the resin sheet **p2** can be suctioned under reduced pressure to be formed into the shape along the inner surface **22b** of the second split mold **22**. In this regard, the inner surface **22b** faces the cavity **cvt**.

(181) The second split mold **22** includes the pinch-off portion **22d**, and the pinch-off portion **22d** surrounds the cavity **cvt**. The pinch-off portion **22d** is the projection formed to protrude from the side of the second split mold **22** to the side of the first split mold **21**. The pinch-off portion **22d** has the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2**. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** are formed in the second outer portion **22a2**.

(182) The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** are similar to the inner

pinch-off portion **21d1** and the outer pinch-off portion **21d2**, respectively. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** faces the cavity cvt. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** is formed in the shape corresponding to the shape of the resin panel **1**. Specifically, the inner pinch-off portion **22d1** has a top portion, and a surface of the top portion is flat. The inner pinch-off portion **22d1** extends in a line having straight lines connected with each other at bent points.

(183) The outer pinch-off portion **22d2** is located further away from the cavity cvt than the inner pinch-off portion **22d1**. The outer pinch-off portion **22d2** is shaped to match the shape of the movable portion **23**.

(184) <Outer Frames **31**, **32**>

(185) As illustrated in FIG. **22** and FIG. **23**, the outer frames **31**, **32** are arranged around the second split mold **22**. Specifically, the outer frame **31** is provided at the top and bottom of the second split mold **22**, respectively, and the outer frame **32** is provided at the left and right sides of the second split mold **22**, respectively. The outer frames **31**, **32** are configured to be movable parallel to the opening and closing direction of the mold. In other words, the outer frames **31**, **32** are configured to move forward and backward in the mold opening and closing direction. Suction holes **31a**, **32a** are formed on the front end faces of the outer frames **31**, **32**, respectively, and the outer frames **31**, **32** can suction the resin sheet p2 by sucking air through the suction holes **31a**, **32a**.

(186) The outer frames **31**, **32** move forward to suck the resin sheet p2, but then, in the embodiment, the outer frames **31**, **32** move backward. By moving backward, the resin sheet p2 is properly shaped along the second split mold **22**, and the interference of the outer frames **31**, **32** with the first split mold **21** and the movable portion **23** is avoided when the first and second split molds **21**, **22** are closed.

(187) Here, as illustrated in FIG. **29**, the outer frame **32** is moved back to the rear edge portion **22ab** of the chamfer portion **22a4**. The same is applied to the outer frame **31**. A backward distance w3 of the outer frames **31**, **32** is within a range from 30 mm to 80 mm. The backward distance w3 (mm) of the outer frames **31**, **32** is specifically 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 65, 70, 75, or 80, for example, and may also be defined within a range between any two of the numerical values exemplified herein.

(188) As illustrated in FIG. **33**, when the outer frame **32** and a suction part **23g** are closest to each other (at the completion in the molding step), a distance t1 between the front edge surface of the outer frame **32** and a front edge surface of the suction part **23g** is preferably 5 mm or more. The distance t1 (mm) is specifically 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, or 15, for example, and may also be defined within a range between any two of the values exemplified herein. In this regard, the same applies to the outer frame **31** and the suction part **21A**. In other words, the distance between the front edge surface of the outer frame **31** and the front edge surface of the suction part **21A** may be defined in the same manner as the distance t1 described above.

(189) <Skin Material Escape Space sp>

(190) A skin material escape space sp illustrated in FIG. **33** and FIG. **34** of the embodiments of the third viewpoint is the same as the skin material escape space sp described in embodiments of the first and second viewpoints (see “<Skin material escape space sp>” in the first and second viewpoints), and therefore, the description is omitted.

(191) 2-1-3. Configuration of Movable Portion **23**

(192) The movable portion **23** has the function of engaging the burr portion and cutting the burr portion. The movable portion **23** is movable relative to the first split mold **21**, as illustrated in FIG. **25A** to FIG. **25c**. The movable portion **23** is provided on the lateral side of the first outer portion **21a2** of the first split mold **21**, as illustrated in FIG. **25B**. The movable portion **23** has the opposing surface portion **23a**, the butting surface portion **23b**, the suction part **23c**, the engaging portion **23d**, the sealing member **23e**, and the suction part **23g**, as illustrated in FIG. **34**.

(193) The opposing surface portion **23a** is provided to oppose the opposing portion **22a3** of the second split mold **22**. The plurality of the engaging portions **23d** are formed on the opposing

surface portion **23a**.

(194) The butting surface portion **23b** is formed to be able to butt against the end face portion **21a3** of the first split mold **21**. The butting surface portion **23b** is formed along the end face portion **21a3**. Therefore, when reduced pressure is generated by sucking air through the decompression suction hole **h1** with the butting surface portion **23b** butting against the end face portion **21a3**, it is possible to prevent air from flowing from the gap between the butting surface portion **23b** and the end face portion **21a3** into space where resin is to be shaped. The sealing member **23e** is also attached to the butting surface portion **23b**. Specifically, the groove is formed in the butting surface portion **23b**, and the sealing member **23e** is attached within the groove. This effectively prevents air from flowing from between the butting surface portion **23b** and the end face portion **21a3** into space where the resin is to be shaped. In this regard, the space where the resin is to be shaped is, for example, the cavity **cvt**, the gap between the burr portion and the surface of the engaging portion **23d**, and the like.

(195) The suction part **23c** is the hole formed in the opposing surface portion **23a** and opens to the area where engaging portion **23d** is formed. When reduced pressure is generated by sucking air through the suction part **23c**, the burr portion (the outer burr portion **5bc2**) is shaped along the engaging portion **23d**. This allows the burr portion (the outer burr portion **5bc2**) to more securely hook onto the movable portion **23** and prevents the burr portion from sliding against the movable portion **23** when the movable portion **23** is moved. As a result, in the embodiment, when the movable portion **23** is moved, the burr portion follows the movable portion **23** properly and the burr portion can be cut more reliably.

(196) The engaging portion **23d** has the function for engaging with the burr portion. The engaging portion **23d** is the protrusion formed to project toward the second split mold **22**. Since the plurality of the engaging portions **23d** are formed on the opposing surface portion **23a**, the opposing surface portion **23a** has the uneven shape in the region where the engaging portions **23d** are formed. In this regard, the embodiment is described as if the suction part **23c** is open in the opposing surface portion **23a** in the area between two adjacent engaging portions **23d**, but is not limited to this. The suction part **23c** may be open on the surface of the engaging portion **23d**.

(197) The suction part **23g** is provided on an end side of the movable portion **23** in a movable direction (a direction in which the movable portion **23** moves from a state in FIG. 25A to a state in FIG. 25C). The suction part **23g** is formed to project from the movable portion **23** side toward the outer frame **32** side. As a result, when the movable portion **23** moves forward together with the first split mold **21**, the front edge portion of the suction part **23g** contacts the resin sheet **p1** prior to the engaging portion **23d**. In this regard, in the embodiment, the position of the front edge portion of the suction part **23g** coincides with the position of the front edge portion of the suction part **21A** of the first split mold **21**. Suction holes **23g1** are formed in the front edge portion of the suction part **23g**, and the suction part **23g** is capable of sucking the resin sheet **p1** by sucking air through the suction holes **23g1**. As illustrated in FIG. 29, the suction part **23g** has a slope surface **23g2**, which facilitates the resin sheet **p1** to follow the surface of the movable part **23** when the resin sheet **p1** is shaped along the movable part **23**. The slope surface **23g2** is connected to the opposing surface portion **23a**.

(198) As illustrated in FIG. 33, a projection amount **t2** of the suction part **23g** (a distance between the position of the front edge portion of the suction part **23g** and the position of the opposing surface portion **23a** in the opening and closing direction of the mold) is preferably 15 mm or more. The projection amount **t2** (mm) is specifically 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, of 30, for example, and may also be defined within a range between any two of the values exemplified herein.

(199) 2-1-4. Insertion Apparatus **19**

(200) The configuration of the insertion apparatus **19** in the third viewpoint is the same as that of the insertion apparatus **19** in the first and second viewpoints, so its description is omitted.

(201) 2-2. Molded Body 5

(202) The molded body 5 of the embodiments in the third viewpoint is similar to the molded body 5 of the embodiments in the first and second viewpoints (see “2-2. Molded Body 5” of the first and second viewpoints), so its description is omitted.

(203) 2-3. Explanation of Each Step of the Manufacturing Method

(204) The manufacturing method of the resin panel 1 of this embodiment includes the skin material attachment step, the hanging step, a suction step, a shaping step, the core member welding step, a molding step, the first cutting step, the molded body removal step, the second cutting step, and the post process.

(205) 2-3-1. Skin Material Attachment Step

(206) In the skin material attachment step, the female projection 19c is inserted in advance into the through hole formed in the skin material 4, and the skin material 4 is held in the insertion apparatus 19, as illustrated in FIG. 21. Since this step is the same as the “2-3-1. Skin Material Attachment Step” in the first and second viewpoints, the explanation is omitted hereafter.

(207) 2-3-2. Hanging Step

(208) In the hanging step, the resin sheets p1, p2 extruded from the T-die 18 are hung between the first and second split molds 21, 22, as illustrated in FIG. 26. Since this step is the same as the “2-3-2. Hanging Step” in the first and second viewpoints, the explanation is omitted hereafter.

(209) 2-3-3. Suction Step

(210) In the suction step, as illustrated in FIG. 27 to FIG. 29, the first split mold 21 and the movable portion 23 move forward together and the suction part 23g contacts the resin sheet p1. The resin sheet p1 is then sucked onto the front edge portion of the suction part 23g by the suction action of the suction holes 23g1 of the suction part 23g. In this regard, since the first split mold 21 is also moving forward in the same manner, the upper and lower suction parts 21A also contact the resin sheet p1, as illustrated in FIG. 27. The resin sheet p1 is then sucked onto the front edge portion of the suction part 21A by the suction action of the suction holes 21B of the suction part 21A. As a result, a closed space SD1 is formed between the resin sheet p1, the first split mold 21 and the movable portion 23, as illustrated in FIG. 29.

(211) As illustrated in FIG. 27 to FIG. 29, the outer frame 32 moves forward and the outer frame 32 contacts the resin sheet p2. The resin sheet p2 is then sucked onto the front end surface of the outer frame 32 by the suction action of the suction holes 32a in the outer frame 32. As illustrated in FIG. 27, the outer frame 31 moves forward in the same manner. The resin sheet p2 is sucked onto the front end face of the outer frame 31 by the suction action of the suction holes 31a of the outer frame 31. As a result, a closed space SD2 is formed between the resin sheet p2, the second split mold 22 and the outer frames 31, 32, as illustrated in FIG. 29.

(212) 2-3-4. Shaping Step

(213) As illustrated in FIG. 30, in the shaping step, air in the closed spaces SD1, SD2 is suctioned through the decompression suction holes h1 of the first and second split molds 21, 22 and the suction part 23c of the movable portion 23 to generate a reduced pressure, and the resin sheets p1, p2 are shaped along the first and second split molds 21, 22 and the movable portion 23. In the shaping step, the outer frames 31, 32, which has been advanced in the suction step, are moved backward. Specifically, the outer frames 31, 32 are moved backward so that the front edge portion of the outer frames 31, 32 matches a position of the rear edge portion 22ab of the chamfer portion 22a4.

(214) As the outer frames 31, 32 move backward, the resin sheet p2 is shaped into a shape along the surface of the second split mold 22. Here, since the second split mold 22 has the chamfer portion 22a4, when the resin sheet p2 moves with the outer frames 31, 32, the resin sheet p2 is smoothly placed along the chamfer portion 22a4. This prevents the resin sheet p2 from peeling off from the second split mold 22 and the outer frames 31, 32, thereby avoiding molding defects.

(215) For example, if the second split mold 22 does not have the chamfer portions 22a4 and instead

has right-angled corners, when the outer frames **31**, **32** move backward from the position of these corners, the resin sheet **p1** will be extended so that the resin sheet **p2** will bend at a right angle starting from these corners. However, depending on physical properties of the resin sheet **p2**, the resin sheet **p2** may not follow the retracting movement of the outer frames **31**, **32** well, and the resin sheet **p2** may separate (peel off) from the outer frames **31**, **32** and the second split mold **22** at these corners and its surrounding portions. In other words, the resin sheet **p2** is forcibly stretched at the corners mentioned above, and the resin sheet **p2** cannot follow the retracting movement of the outer frames **31**, **32** well, causing the resin sheet **p2** to peel off from the outer frames **31**, **32** and the second split mold **22**. In such a case, the resin sheet **p2** is not properly shaped with reduced pressure, leading to leakage of the closed space **SD2**.

(216) However, in the embodiment, the second split mold **22** has the chamfer portion **22a4**, so when the outer frames **31**, **32** are moved backward and the resin sheet **p1** moves with the outer frames **31**, **32**, the resin sheet **p1** follows along the chamfer portion **22a4**, and peeling of the resin sheet **p1** from the second split mold **22** is avoided. In this regard, a method of improving the tracking of the resin sheet **p1** by slowing down the retracting speed of the outer frames **31**, **32** could be considered, but such a method has the disadvantage that it not only increases the molding time of the molded body **5**, but also creates restrictions on the manufacturing conditions in the other steps. However, in the manufacturing method of the embodiment, there is no need to slow down the retracting speed of the outer frames **31**, **32**, which avoids lengthening the time to mold the molded body **5**, and also avoids creating restrictions on the manufacturing conditions.

(217) In this regard, the timing of starting the suction to generate the reduced pressure and the timing of starting the moving the outer frames **31**, **32** backward may be simultaneous or may be different from each other.

(218) The resin sheets **p1**, **p2** may be shaped at different times, for example, the resin sheet **p2** may be shaped after the core member welding step, or the resin sheet **p2** may be shaped in the mold clamping step. The suction part **23c** may become reduced pressure after the molding step described below.

(219) 2-3-5. Core Member Welding Step

(220) As illustrated in FIG. **30** and FIG. **31**, the insertion apparatus **19** has the skin material **4** attached to the first split mold **21**, so the core member **3** is left in the insertion apparatus **19**. In this state, the core member **3** can be welded to the resin sheet **p1** by moving the insertion apparatus **19** toward the resin sheet **p1**. Since this step is similar to the “2-3-4. Core Member Welding Step” of the first and second viewpoints, the description is omitted hereafter.

(221) 2-3-6 Molding Step

(222) In the molding step, the first and second split molds **21**, **22** are closed. As a result, the resin sheets **p1**, **p2** are squashed and welded together at the portions corresponding to the pinch-off portion **21d** and the pinch-off portion **22d** to form the molded body **5** illustrated in FIG. **15**.

(223) In this regard, in the state where the molding step is completed, at least a part of the movable portion **23** (the suction portion **23g** in the embodiment) is positioned closer to the outer frame **32** than the position of the front edge portion **22af** of the chamfer portion **22a4**. The same is true for the suction part **21A**, which is omitted in the figure, and the suction part **21A** is positioned closer to the outer frame **31** than the position of the front edge portion **22af** of the chamfer portion **22a4**. Since the outer frames **31**, **32** are appropriately moved backward during the shaping step, contact between the members is avoided.

(224) 2-3-8. First Cutting Step, Molded Body Removal Step, Second Cutting Step, and Post Process

(225) These steps are the same as “2-3-7. First cutting step” through “2-3-10. Post Process” in the first and second viewpoints, so the description is omitted.

3. Other Embodiments

(226) The chamfer portion **22a4** is not limited to a tapered surface. The chamfer portion **22a4** can

be shaped so that the distance between the chamfer portion **22a4** and the resin sheet **P2** widens in the direction from the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** to the outer frame **32**. For example, the chamfer portion **22a4** may include a plurality of tapered surfaces (a plurality of slope surfaces) with different slope angles.

(227) In the embodiment, the tapered surface of the chamfer portion **22a4** is formed in a flat shape, but it may be formed in a curved shape, or the flat and curved surfaces may be combined.

(228) If the distance between the chamfer portion **22a4** and the resin sheet **p2** widens in the direction from the outer pinch-off portion **22d2** to the outer frame **32**, the chamfer portion **22a4** may have one or more stepped portions (portions formed in the form of steps).

(229) In the embodiment, the second split mold **22** is described as having four chamfer portions **22a4**, but it is not limited to this. For example, the second split mold **22** may be provided with only the left and right chamfer portions **22a4** and without the upper and lower chamfer portions **22a4**, or vice versa. Furthermore, the second split mold **22** may be configured with only one of the four chamfer portions **22a4** on the top, bottom, left and right sides.

(230) In the embodiment, the molding machine **10** is described as having the movable portion **23**, but it is not limited to this and may not have the movable portion **23**.

(231) In the embodiment, an example is given of the configuration in which a pair of the movable portions **23** are arranged on the left and right sides of the first split mold **21**, but the embodiment is not limited to this configuration. In addition to the movable portions **23** on the left and right sides of the first split mold **21**, the movable portions **23** may be further disposed at the bottom of the first split mold **21**. The movable portions **23** may be disposed at the bottom of the first split mold **21** instead of the movable portions **23** on the left and right sides of the first split mold **21**.

Fourth Viewpoint

1. Configuration of Panel

(232) A configuration of a panel **101** is described using FIG. 35A through FIG. 38. As illustrated in FIG. 35A and FIG. 35B, the panel **101** has a resin panel body **102** and a skin material **108**. The resin panel body **102** is formed by integrating a first body portion **102a**, a second body portion **102b**, and a hinge **105**. FIG. 35a illustrates the front surface side (front side) of the resin panel body **102**, and the skin material **108** is attached to cover the entirety of the front surface of the resin panel body **102**. The skin material **108** is adhered to the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b** across the hinge **105**. The back surface of the resin panel body **102** is exposed.

(233) The panel **101** is a rectangular flat panel with an overall length $L_{sub.0}$ and a width W_o . In the embodiment, as an example, the first body portion **102a**, the second body portion **102b**, and the hinge **105** have the same overall length as each other, and all of them have the same overall length $L_{sub.0}$ as the panel **101**. In the embodiment, as an example, the first body portion **102a** has a width $W_{sub.a}$ and the second body portion **102b** has a width $W_{sub.b}$ (wherein, $W_{sub.b} < W_{sub.a}$). Including the width of the hinge **105** ($W_{sub.h}$ in FIG. 38), $W_{sub.0} = W_{sub.a} + W_{sub.b} + W_{sub.h}$.

(234) As illustrated in FIG. 36A, the hinge **105** extends between the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b**. In the embodiment, as an example, the hinge **105** has three hinge portions **105h** and two slits **105s**. In the example of FIG. 36A, each length $L_{sub.h}$ of the hinge portions **105h** is very small relative to the total length $L_{sub.0}$ of the hinge **105**. The three hinge portions **105h** rotatably connect the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b**. The slit **105s** is provided adjacent to the hinge portion **105h** to separate the first body portion **102a** from the second body portion **102b**. The slit **105s** improves the bendability of the hinge **105**.

(235) FIG. 37 is an enlarged view of portions B1-B3 of FIG. 36A. As an example, the hinge portion **105h** has one middle hinge portion **105h1** and two extremity hinge portions **105h2**. The two extremity hinge portions **105h2** are provided at both ends of the hinge **105**, respectively. The middle hinge portion **105h1** is provided on the inner side of the hinge **105** than at the ends of the hinge **105**. As an example in the embodiment, the middle hinge portion **105h1** is provided just in the middle of the hinge **105** (i.e., centered by $L_{sub.0}/2$ from the end of the hinge **105**).

(236) FIG. 38 illustrates a cross-section along the C-C line of FIG. 37. The resin panel body **102** has a front wall **103** and a back wall **104**. The front wall **103** and the back wall **104** are spaced apart and facing each other. A hollow **107** is provided between the front wall **103** and the back wall **104**. In this regard, the front wall **103** and the back wall **104** are connected by a peripheral wall (not shown). A surface of the front wall **103** is flat. The back wall **104** is recessed toward the front wall **103** to form the hinge **105**. The back wall **104** has a slope portion **104a** adjacent to the hinge **105**. In the slope portion **104a**, the distance between the front wall **103** and the back wall **104** becomes narrower the closer to the hinge **105**.

(237) The hinge **105** has the width W_h . The slit **105s** may be a cutout along a single line, or may be a slot created by opening through the hinge **105**. The width (or thickness) of the slit **105s** is also referred to as a slit width $W_{sub.S}$. If the slit **105s** is the cutout along a single-line, the slit width $W_{sub.S}$ is substantially zero. As an example, when a ratio $W_{sub.S}/W_{sub.h}$ between the width $W_{sub.S}$ of the slit **105s** and the width $W_{sub.h}$ of the hinge is defined, $W_{sub.S}/W_{sub.h}$ may be, for example, 0 to 1, specifically, 0, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.6, 0.7, 0.8, 0.9, 1, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here. The slit width $W_{sub.S}$ may be $W_{sub.S} < W_{sub.h}$ as an example, however, the slit width may be so thick that $W_{sub.S} = W_{sub.h}$. In this regard, the width of the hinge portion **105h** is the same width $W_{sub.h}$ as the hinge **105**. In this regard, when the slit width W_S is large, a part of the skin material **108** is exposed through the slit **105s**.

(238) As illustrated in FIG. 38, the skin material **108** is provided on the front wall **103** side of the panel **101**. The skin material **108** is provided from the first body portion **102a** to the second body portion **102b** across the hinge **105**. The skin material **108** may be made of an air-permeable carpet-like material, such as a non-woven fabric.

(239) Each thickness of the front wall **103** and the back wall **104** in the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b** is, for example, 0.5 to 2 mm, specifically 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, and 2.0 mm, and may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(240) As illustrated in FIG. 36A, the hinge portion **105h** alternates with the slit **105s** along the direction in which the hinge **105** extends. The two slits **105s** have slit lengths $L_{sub.S1}$ and $L_{sub.S2}$, respectively. In the embodiment, $L_{sub.S1} = L_{sub.S2}$ as an example. The three hinge portions **105h** have the same length $L_{sub.h}$ as an example in the embodiment. Therefore, $L_{sub.0} = 3L_{sub.h} + L_{sub.S1} + L_{sub.S2}$. In this regard, " $L_{S1} + L_{S2}$ " is also referred to as a total slit length $L_{sub.S}$.

(241) The thickness of the hinge portion **105h** is, for example, 0.001 to 1.0 mm, specifically, for example, 0.001, 0.01, 0.1, 0.2, 0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.6, 0.7, 0.8, 0.9, 1.0 mm, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here. The width $W_{sub.h}$ of the hinge portion **105h** (i.e., the width $W_{sub.h}$ of the hinge **105**) is, for example, 1 to 8 mm, specifically, 1.0, 1.5, 2.0, 2.5, 3.0, 3.5, 4.0, 4.5, 5.0, 5.5, 6.0, 6.5, 7.0, 7.5, 8.0 mm, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(242) In this regard, the thickness of the hinge **105** (i.e., the thickness of the hinge portion **105h**) means the thickness excluding the thickness of the skin material **108**. In addition, the values of thickness and width, etc. of the various members mean average values unless otherwise specified.

(243) The total length L_0 of the hinge **105** is the length over both ends of the hinge **105**. The total slit length L_S is the sum of the lengths of the slits **105s**. The larger the ratio $L_{sub.S}/L_{sub.0}$ is, the larger the proportion of the slits **105s** in the hinge **105** becomes, and the smaller the proportion of the hinge portions **105h** in the hinge **105** (i.e., the total of the lengths $L_{sub.h}$ of the plurality of the hinge portions **105h**) correspondingly becomes. $L_{sub.S}/L_{sub.0}$ may be, for example, 0.50 to 0.99, for example, 0.70 to 0.97. $L_{sub.S}/L_{sub.0}$ may be, specifically, 0.50, 0.55, 0.60, 0.65, 0.70, 0.75, 0.80, 0.85, 0.86, 0.87, 0.88, 0.89, 0.90, 0.91, 0.92, 0.93, 0.94, 0.95, 0.96, 0.97, 0.98, 0.99, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(244) The length $L_{sub.h}$ of each hinge portion **105h** can be arbitrarily determined. As an example,

the length $L_{\text{sub.h}}$ of the hinge portion **105h** may be 10 mm, but is not limited to this, for example, 5 to 15 mm, or even 2 to 100 mm, for example. The length $L_{\text{sub.h}}$ is specifically 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 35, 40, 45, 50, 55, 60, 70, 80, 90, 100 mm for example, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here. The length $L_{\text{sub.h}}$ may be increased to some extent to ensure a certain level of strength.

(245) The number of the hinge portions **105h** in the hinge **105** is not limited to three, but may be two, or may be four or more. The number of the hinge portions **105h** may be specifically 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, or 10, for example. The number of the hinge portions **105h** may also be within a range between any two of the numbers exemplified here. The plurality of the hinge portions **105h** may all have the same length L_h , or they may have different lengths from one another. For example, $L_{\text{sub.h1}} < L_{\text{sub.h2}}$ or $L_{\text{sub.h1}} > L_{\text{sub.h2}}$ may be satisfied when comparing a length $L_{\text{sub.h1}}$ of one middle hinge portion **105h1** with a length $L_{\text{sub.h2}}$ of one extremity hinge portion **105h2**. Within the aforementioned numerical range, one length $L_{\text{sub.h}}$ of one hinge portion **105h** may differ from another length $L_{\text{sub.h}}$ of another hinge portion **105h**.

(246) The interval at which the hinge portion **105h** is provided is determined by the length of each of the slits **105s**. The lengths of the plurality of the slits **105s** may be the same, or may be different from each other. If the slits **105s** are shortened so that the hinge portions **105h** are closer together, strength can be increased. On the other hand, if the slits **105s** are lengthened so that the hinge portions **105h** are set farther apart from each other, the bendability of the hinge **105** can be increased.

(247) The slit **105s** improves the bendability. Since the bendability can be adjusted with the slit **105s**, the hinge portion **105h** does not have to be made too thin, which has the advantage of suppressing pinch-off and preventing the hinge portion **105h** from shredding, etc. In addition, the skin material **108** is provided in the embodiment, so that the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b** can be rotatably connected by both the hinge portion **105h** and the skin material **108**. High strength can be achieved if the skin material **108** is made of a sufficiently thick material.

(248) The bendability of the hinge **105** can be controlled in various ways, and the number, length, width, and, at least, the depth or thickness of the slits **105s** and hinge portion **105h** can be changed as desired, depending on the degree of bendability (flexibility) required. FIG. 39 shows an example of a bending angle θ of the hinge **105**. The bending angle θ caused by a self-weight of the second body portion **102b** may be, for example, 45° or more, 60° or more, 70° or more, or 85° or more. The bending angle θ caused by the self-weight of the second body portion **102b** may specifically be, for example, 45°, 50°, 55°, 60°, 65°, 70°, 75°, 80°, 85° or 90°, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(249) However, although the hinge **105** may easily bend by the self-weight of the second body portion **102b**, the configuration of the hinge **105** is not limited to this. The hinge **105** may not bend at all by the self-weight of the second body portion **102b** (i.e., θ in FIG. 39 due to the self-weight may be substantially 0°), or may bend only slightly (e.g., $0^\circ < \theta \leq 15^\circ$ or $0^\circ < \theta \leq 30^\circ$, or $0^\circ < \theta \leq 45^\circ$ or the like). Even in these cases, the slit **105s** may be provided so that the hinge **105** can be easily bent when a force is applied to the second body portion **102b**.

(250) In this regard, the total length L_0 of the panel **101** may be within a range from 500 to 1300 mm as an example. The total length L_0 may specifically be 500, 600, 700, 800, 900, 1000, 1100, 1200, 1300 mm, for example, and may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here. The panel **101** may be provided, for example, as a luggage board, a deck board, or a cargo floor board, etc. for automobiles.

(251) The relationship between the width W_a of the first body portion **102a** and the width W_b of the second body portion **102b** described in FIG. 35a, etc. can be set arbitrarily. If the width W_b of the second body portion **102b** is large, the hinge **105** tends to bend by the self-weight of the second body portion **102b**. Therefore, when $W_b < W_a$, the width ratio W_b/W_a may be, for example, 0.20 to

0.80, or for example, 0.40 to 0.60. The width ratio W_b/W_a may be specifically 0.20, 0.25, 0.30, 0.35, 0.40, 0.45, 0.50, 0.55, 0.60, 0.65, 0.70, 0.75, 0.80, 0.85, 0.90, 0.95, or may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here. However, it is not limited to the above numerical values and may be $W_b=W_a$ (i.e., $W_b/W_a=1.0$) or $W_b>W_a$.

(252) Any two or more of the various modifications described above may be used in combination with each other.

2. Manufacturing Method of Panel **101**

(253) The following is an example of a method for manufacturing the panel **101**. This method includes a preparation step, a slit forming step, and an attaching step. Specifically, first, the resin panel body **102** is prepared in the preparation step, before the slit is formed. The slit **105s** is formed and the skin material **108** is attached to the resin panel body **102**.

(254) 2-1. Configuration of Molding Machine

(255) First, FIG. **40** is used to describe the molding machine **10** that can be used to implement the method of manufacturing the resin panel body **102**. The molding machine **10** is equipped with the pair of the sheet forming devices **14** and molds **121**, **131**. Each sheet forming device **14** has the hopper **12**, the extruder **13**, the accumulator **17**, and the T-die **18**. The extruder **13** and the accumulator **17** are connected via the connecting tube **15**. The accumulator **17** and the T-die **18** are connected via the connecting tube **16**.

(256) In the embodiments of the fourth viewpoint illustrated in FIG. **40**, the sheet forming device **14** and resin used therein are the same as the sheet forming device **14** and the resin used therein in the embodiments of the first and second viewpoints (see “2-1-1. Configuration of Sheet Forming Device **14**” in the first and second viewpoints). Therefore, the explanation is omitted.

(257) <Molds **121**, **131**>

(258) The molds **121**, **131** can be opened and closed, and when the molds **121**, **131** are opened, resin sheets **123**, **133** are extruded therebetween. As illustrated in FIG. **40**, the molds **121**, **131** include cavity surfaces **121a**, **131a** and pinch-off portions **121b**, **131b** surrounding the cavity surfaces **121a**, **131a**, respectively. Decompression suction holes (not shown) are formed in the cavity surfaces **121a**, **131a**, and through the decompression suction holes, the resin sheets **123**, **133** can be suctioned under reduced pressure and shaped into a shape along the cavity surfaces **121a**, **131a**. The thickness of the resin sheets **123**, **133** is, for example, within a range from 0.5 to 2 mm. The thickness of the resin sheets **123**, **133** is specifically, for example, 0.5, 1.0, 1.5, and 2.0 mm, and may be within a range between any two of the values exemplified here.

(259) The mold **131** is provided with a projecting stripe **135** to form the hinge **105**. The projecting stripe **135** is an elongated projection. The projecting stripe **135** is preferably configured so that the longitudinal direction of the projecting stripe **135** is non-parallel to the extrusion direction of the resin sheets **123**, **133**. Even more preferably, the projecting stripe **135** is configured so that the longitudinal direction of the projecting stripe **135** is perpendicular to the extrusion direction of the resin sheets **123**, **133**. This can achieve the suppression of thickness variation in the resin sheets **123**, **133** along the longitudinal direction of the hinge **105**.

(260) 2-2. Preparation Step (Manufacturing Process of Panel Main Body)

(261) In the preparation step, the resin panel body **102** is prepared prior to the formation of the slit **105s**. The preparation step in the embodiments includes, in more detail, an extrusion step, a shaping step, and a mold closing step.

(262) In the extrusion step, the resin sheets **123**, **133** are extruded between the molds **121**, **131**, as illustrated in FIG. **40**. The resin sheet **133** is placed between the resin sheet **123** and the mold **131**.

(263) Next, in the shaping step, the resin sheets **123**, **133** are shaped along the cavity surfaces **121a**, **131a** of the molds **121**, **131**, respectively. This step can be implemented by suctioning the resin sheets **123**, **133** under the reduced pressure using the molds **121**, **131**.

(264) Next, the molds **121**, **131** are closed in the mold closing step. As the molds **121**, **131** are closed, the resin sheets **123**, **133** are welded to each other along the pinch-off portions **121b**, **131b**

to obtain the resin panel body **102** shaped along the inner surface of the cavity formed by the pair of the molds **121**, **131**. Between the projecting stripe **135** and the mold **121**, the resin sheets **123**, **133** are compressed to form the hinge **105** (see FIG. **41**). Outer portions outside the pinch-off portions **121b**, **131b** become burrs. After this, the molds **121**, **131** are opened and the panel **101** is removed, and the burrs are removed to obtain the resin panel body **102** before the slits **105s** are formed.

(265) 2-3. Slit Forming Step

(266) Next, the slits **105s** of a predetermined number and length are provided in the hinge **105** of the resin panel body **102**. There is no limitation on the specific means of forming the slits **105s**, for example, a press, an ultrasonic cutter, or a knife may be used.

(267) 2-4. Attaching Step of Skin Material **108**

(268) Next, the panel **101** is provided by attaching the skin material **108** to the resin panel body **102** with adhesive. Since this post-attachment process is performed, there is no limitation on the material of the skin material **108** in the embodiments. Since the post-attachment does not require breathability, this provides the advantage of a rich variation of available skin material **108**. For example, the skin material **108** need not be a non-woven fabric, but may be nonbreathable skin material such as synthetic leather, for example.

(269) As explained above, according to the embodiments, the bendability of the hinge **105** can be improved by the novel approach of providing the slit **105s**. In particular, according to the embodiments, properly designing the slit **105s** and the hinge portion **105h** in accordance with the variations in various embodiments can provide the advantage of both controlling the bendability of the hinge **105**, ensuring durability, and mass production. In other words, since the hinge portion **105h** connects the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b**, the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b** are not separated into separate parts. This makes it easier to perform the post-attachment process of the skin material **108**, and also suppresses undesirable manufacturing variations in the size (width WO) of the panel **101**. It is also easier to control the bendability of the hinge unit **105** to the desired degree by adjusting the length Lh of the hinge portion **105h**.

3. Modifications

(270) Various modifications may be applied to the above described embodiments. For example, the skin material **108** may be omitted from the panel **101**.

(271) The structure of the resin panel body **102** is an example, and various structures may be applied to the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b**. As an example, a core member made of a foamed body may be provided in the hollow unit **107**. The distance between the front wall **103** and the back wall **104** in the hollow **107** can be secured using the foamed body as the core member, and also increases the strength and thermal insulation of the panel **101**. To provide the core member, an insert step may be performed between the shaping step and the mold closing step. In the insert step, a foamed body having a thinner recess at the position of the projecting stripe **135** can be placed between the resin sheets **123**, **133**, and then proceed to the mold closing step. As another example, the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b** may be constructed of a foam resin sheet that does not have the hollow **107**. As another example, reinforcing ribs may be provided at predetermined intervals at any position in the width direction in the first body portion **102a** and the second body portion **102b**. A plurality of the reinforcing ribs may be provided by depressing portions of the back wall **104** toward the front wall **103** and welding them to the inner surface of the front wall **103**, which may increase the rigidity and strength of the resin panel body **102**.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

First to Third Viewpoints

(272) **1**: resin panel, **2**: resin molded body, **3**: core member, **3a**: base member, **3a1**: recessed portion, **3b**: base body, **3b1**: recessed portion, **3c**: reinforcing member, **3c1**: upper wall, **3c11**:

projection, **3c2**: bottom wall, **3c21**: projection, **3c3**: pillar portion, **4**: skin material, **5**: molded body, **5a**: molded main body, **5b**: large burr portion, **5bb**: bottom burr portion, **5bc1**: inner burr portion, **5bc2**: outer burr portion, **5bu**: upper burr portion, **5c**: cutting line, **5cb**: bottom line, **5cl**: left line, **5cr**: right line, **5cu**: upper line, **5d**: molded member, **Se**: small burr portion, **5f**: parting line, **5fb**: bottom line, **5fl**: left line, **5fr**: right line **5fu**: upper line, **9a**: base, **9b**: suction pad, **10**: molding machine, **11**: raw material resin, **11a**: molten resin, **12**: hopper, **13**: extruder, **13a**: cylinder, **14**: sheet forming device, **15**: connecting tube, **16**: connecting tube, **17**: accumulator, **17a**: cylinder, **17b**: piston, **18**: T-die, **19**: insertion apparatus, **19a**: base, **19b**: suction pad, **19c**: female projection, **21**: first split mold, **21A**: suction part, **21B**: suction hole, **21C**: slope surface, **21a1**: main body, **21a2**: first outer portion, **21a3**: end face portion, **21b**: inner surface, **21d**: pinch-off portion, **21d1**: inner pinch-off portion **21d2**: outer pinch-off portion, **21dd**: pinch-off portion, **21e**: male projection, **21f**: supporting portion, **22**: second split mold, **22a**: rear edge portion, **22a1**: main body, **22a2**: second outer portion, **22a3**: opposing portion, **22a4**: chamfer portion, **22ab**: rear edge portion, **22af**: front edge portion, **22b**: inner surface, **22d**: pinch-off portion, **22d1**: inner pinch-off portion, **22d2**: outer pinch-off portion, **22dd**: pinch-off portion, **23**: movable portion, **23a**: opposing surface portion, **23b**: butting surface portion, **23c**: suction part, **23d**: engaging portion, **23e**: sealing member, **23f**: supported portion, **23g**: suction part, **23g1**: suction hole, **23g2**: slope surface, **24**: drive mechanism, **24a**: upper drive mechanism, **24b**: lower drive mechanism, **31**: outer frame, **31a**: suction hole **32**: outer frame, **32a**: suction hole, **A**: area, **Ar**: arrow, **B**: area, **C1**: arrow, **C2**: arrow, **Dr**: thickness direction, **PL**: parting line, **SD1**: closed space, **SD2**: closed space, **cvt**: cavity, **h1**: decompression suction hole, **p1**: resin sheet, **p2**: resin sheet, **sp**: space, **w1**: width dimension, **w2**: depth dimension, **t1**: distance, **t2**: projection amount, **w3**: backward distance

Fourth Viewpoint

(273) **101**: panel, **102**: resin panel body, **102a**: first body portion, **102b**: second body portion, **103**: front wall, **104**: back wall, **104a**: slope portion, **105**: hinge, **105h**: hinge portion, **105h1**: middle hinge portion, **105h2**: extremity hinge portion, **105s**: slit, **107**: hollow, **108**: skin material, **10**: molding machine, **11**: raw material resin, **12**: hopper, **13**: extruder, **13a**: cylinder, **17**: accumulator, **17a**: cylinder, **17b**: piston, **18**: T-die, **14**: sheet forming device, **121**: mold, **121a**: cavity surface, **121b**: pinch-off portion, **123**: resin sheet, **15**: connecting tube, **16**: connecting tube, **131**: mold, **131a**: cavity surface, **131b**: pinch-off portion, **133**: resin sheet, **135**: projecting stripe, **L.sub.0**: total length of hinge, **L.sub.S**: total length of slit(s), **L.sub.S1**, **L.sub.S2**: slit length, **L.sub.h**: length of hinge portion, **W.sub.S**: slit width

Claims

1. A method for manufacturing a structure, comprising: a molding step; a burr portion shaping step; and a cutting step, wherein, in the molding step, a molded body is molded using a mold, the mold includes a movable portion and a pair of first and second split molds, each of the first and second split molds includes a cavity and a pinch-off portion, the movable portion is provided to be movable relative to the first and second split molds, and the movable portion includes a suction part and an engaging portion, the molded body includes a molded main body, a cutting line, and a burr portion, the molded main body is molded in the cavity in the molding step, the cutting line is squashed by the pinch-off portion in the molding step; and the burr portion is connected to the molded main body via the cutting line, and is provided on the movable portion, in the burr portion shaping step, the burr portion is shaped along the engaging portion by suctioning the burr portion to the engaging portion via the suction part, in the cutting step, the burr portion is cut from the molded main body along the cutting line by moving the movable portion relative to the first and second split molds with the burr portion shaped along the engaging portion.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the first split mold includes an end face portion, the movable portion includes a butting surface portion, and in the burr portion shaping step, the butting surface

portion is butted against the end face portion.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein the mold further includes a sealing member, and the sealing member is attached to the end face portion or the butting surface portion.

4. The method of claim 2, wherein the first split mold includes a first outer portion, the pinch-off portion of the first split mold is formed on the first outer portion, and the end face portion is formed on the first outer portion, the second split mold includes a second outer portion, and the pinch-off portion of the second split mold is formed on the second outer portion, and the second outer portion is positioned to face the first outer portion in a direction in which the first and second split molds open and close.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the molded body includes a resin sheet and a skin material, and the skin material is disposed on an outer side of the resin sheet.

6. The method according to claim 5, wherein each of the first and second split molds includes a reduced pressure suction hole, the reduced pressure suction hole communicates with the cavity, and the reduced pressure suction hole is formed to shape the resin sheet along the first and second split molds, with the first and second split molds shaping the resin sheet, the skin material in the cavity is provided along the first split mold, and the reduced pressure suction hole is not formed in the first outer portion of the first split mold.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein a skin material escape space is formed between the first outer portion and the second outer portion, and in the molding step, an edge of the skin material is disposed in the skin material escape space.

8. A method for manufacturing a structure, comprising: a molding step; an engaging step; and a cutting step, wherein, in the molding step, a molded body is molded using a mold, the mold includes a movable portion and a pair of first and second split molds, each of the first and second split molds includes a cavity, an inner pinch-off portion, and an outer pinch-off portion, the inner pinch-off portion is connected to the cavity, the outer pinch-off portion is located further away from the cavity than the inner pinch-off portion, the movable portion is provided to be movable relative to the first and second split molds, and the movable portion includes an engaging portion, the molded body includes a molded main body, an outer line portion, and an outer burr portion, the molded main body includes an inner line portion and an inner burr portion, the molded main body is molded in the cavity in the molding step, the inner line portion is squashed by the inner pinch-off portion in the molding step, the inner burr portion is formed between the inner line portion and the outer line portion, the outer line portion is squashed by the outer pinch-off portion in the molding step, the outer burr portion is connected to the outer line portion, in the engaging step, the outer burr portion is engaged with the engaging portion of the movable portion, and in the cutting step, the outer burr portion is cut from the inner burr portion along the outer line portion by moving the movable portion relative to the first and second split molds with the outer burr portion engaged with the engaging portion; wherein the movable portion further includes a suction part, and in the engaging step, the outer burr portion is suctioned to the engaging portion via the suction part, the outer burr portion is shaped along the engaging portion, and thereby the outer burr portion is engaged along the engaging portion.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein, when the first split mold and the movable portion are viewed in plain view, the outer pinch-off portion is formed along the engaging portion.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein, a surface of a top portion of the outer pinch-off portion is aligned with the surface of a top portion of the engaging portion.

11. The method of claim 8, wherein the first split mold includes an end face portion, the movable portion includes a butting surface portion, and in the engaging step, with the butting surface portion butted against the end face portion, the outer burr portion is suctioned to the engaging portion via the suction part.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the mold further includes a sealing member, and the sealing member is attached to the end face portion or the butting surface portion.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein the first split mold includes a first outer portion, the first outer portion includes the inner pinch-off portion and the outer pinch-off portion of the first split mold, and the first outer portion includes the end face portion, the second split mold includes a second outer portion, and the second outer portion includes the inner pinch-off portion and the outer pinch-off portion of the second split mold, and the second outer portion is positioned to face the first outer portion in a direction in which the first and second split molds open and close.
14. The method of claim 8, wherein the molded body includes a resin sheet and a skin material, and the skin material is disposed on an outer side of the resin sheet.
15. The method according to claim 14, wherein each of the first and second split molds includes a reduced pressure suction hole, the reduced pressure suction hole communicates with the cavity, and the reduced pressure suction hole is formed to shape the resin sheet along the first and second split molds, with the first and second split molds shaping the resin sheet, the skin material in the cavity is provided along the first split mold, and the reduced pressure suction hole is not formed in the first outer portion of the first split mold.
16. A method for manufacturing a structure using a mold and an outer frame, the method comprising: a hanging step; a suction step, and a shaping step, wherein, in the hanging step, a molten resin sheet is hung in front of the mold, the mold includes a cavity, a pinch-off portion, and a chamfer portion, the chamfer portion is provided between the outer frame and the pinch-off portion and is formed so that the distance between the chamfer portion and the hung resin sheet increases in a direction from the pinch-off portion to the outer frame, in the suction step, the outer frame is advanced and the resin sheet is suctioned by the outer frame to form a closed space between the outer frame, the resin sheet, and the mold, the outer frame is positioned around the mold and is configured to suck the resin sheet, in the shaping step, the outer frame is backed and the closed space is depressurized to shape the resin sheet by the cavity, and the resin sheet moves with the outer frame as the outer frame is backed and is positioned along the chamfer portion.
17. The method of claim 16, wherein the chamfer portion includes a tapered surface.
18. The method of claim 16, wherein, in the shaping step, the outer frame is backed up to a position of a rear edge portion of the chamfer portion.
19. The method of claim 16, wherein the method further using a movable portion, and the method further comprises a molding step, the mold includes first and second split molds, the movable portion is configured to move relative to the first split mold to cut a portion of the resin sheet, and is provided around the first split mold, the second split mold includes the chamfer portion, and the outer frame is positioned around the second split mold, and in the molding step, the first and second split molds are closed, and when the molding step is completed, at least a portion of the movable portion is positioned closer to the outer frame than a position of a front edge portion of the chamfer portion.
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